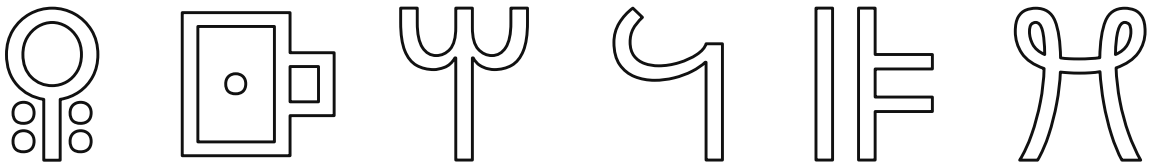
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 61

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Vai Syllables



A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 56 Vai Syllables with English Phonetics

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Vai Syllables — 𖬁𖬚
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 61

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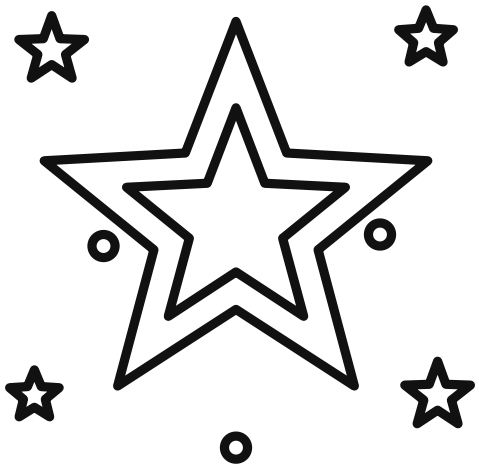
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans Vai, Baloo 2, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

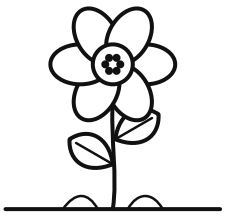


This book belongs to

I started learning Vai on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 61 is Vai. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Each syllable has an **easy English sound**: *eh*, *ee*, *ah*, *aw*, *oo*, *oh*, *ay* for the seven vowels.
- The box on each page also gives the **standard Latin spelling** of Vai, where **ɛ** says *eh* and **ɔ** says *aw*.
- Vai is a **tone language**: a high or low voice changes meaning. The script does not show tones, so neither does this book.
- Vai also has sounds that English lacks (*kp*, *gb*, *ɓ*) and nasal syllables; they are in the full chart but not in this first book.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Vai name** written in Vai (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The third box shows the syllable's **row** in the Vai chart (the same consonant with all seven vowels), with the syllable itself in a box.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Vai of Liberia; the sound guides are approximate and do not show tones.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Vai! ꕙꔤ

VAH-ee — the Vai word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **100,000 Vai people** speak Vai.[3]

Where?
In the west of **Liberia**, around Robertsport and Grand Cape Mount, and in the south-east of **Sierra Leone**, near the Atlantic coast. Most Vai families are **Muslim**.

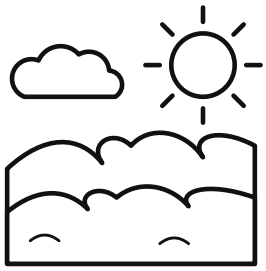
How is it written?
In its own **syllabary**, from **left to right**. Each sign stands for a whole syllable, like ꔞ *ba*.

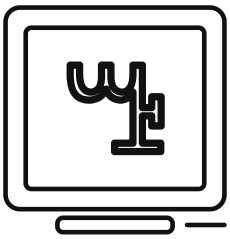
How many signs?
About **200**. This book teaches the **56** most useful first: 7 vowels and 7 rows.

A script from West Africa
The Vai script was made around **1833** by **Momolu Duwalu Bukele**. It is one of the oldest scripts invented in West Africa, and Vai people taught it to each other at home.

Did you know?
The name ꕙꔤ *Vai* is written with just two signs: ꕙ *va* and ꔤ *i*.

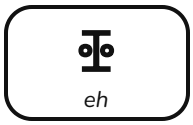
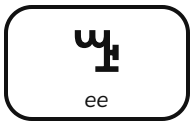
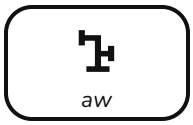
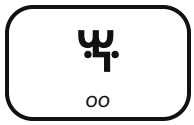
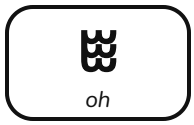




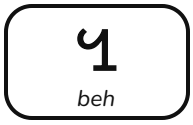
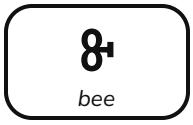
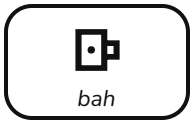
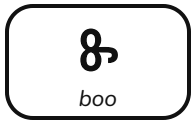
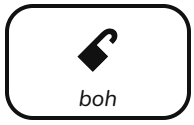


The Vai Alphabet ꕉꔬ

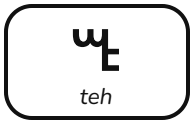
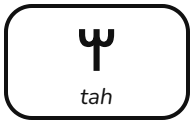
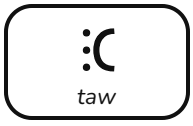
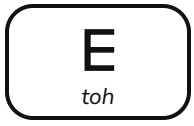
7 vowels — ꔰ

 *eh*	 *ee*	 *ah*	 *aw*	 *oo*	 *oh*	 *ay*

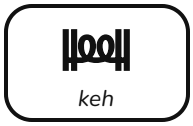
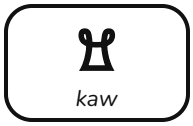
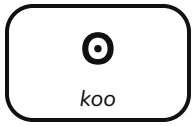
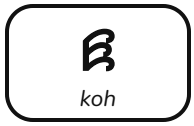
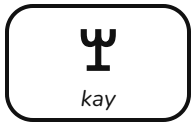
7 b row — ꕓ

 *beh*	 *bee*	 *bah*	 *baw*	 *boo*	 *boh*	 *bay*

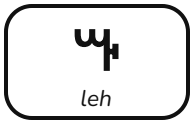
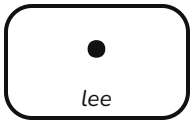
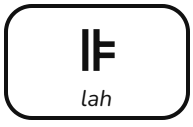
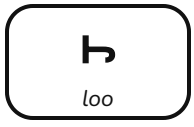
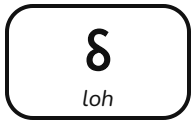
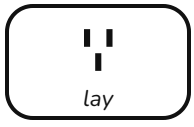
7 t row — ꔶ

 *teh*	 *tee*	 *tah*	 *taw*	 *too*	 *toh*	 *tay*

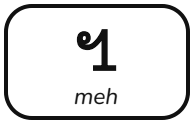
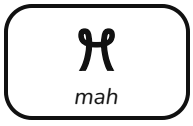
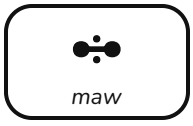
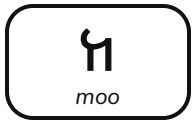
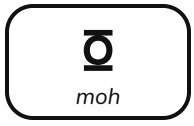
7 k row — ꕆ

 *keh*	 *kee*	 *kah*	 *kaw*	 *koo*	 *koh*	 *kay*

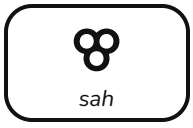
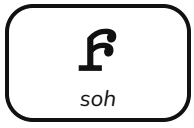
7 l row — ꕯ

 *leh*	 *lee*	 *lah*	 *law*	 *loo*	 *loh*	 *lay*

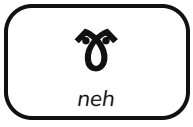
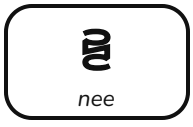
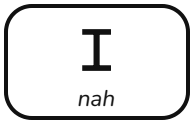
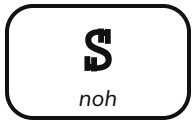
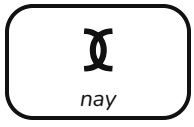
7 m row — ꕣ

 *meh*	 *mee*	 *mah*	 *maw*	 *moo*	 *moh*	 *may*

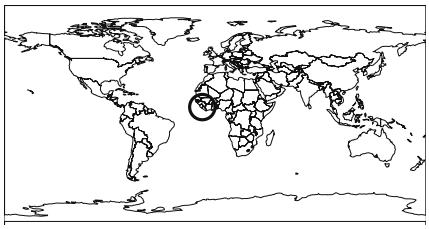
7 s row — ꕤ

 *seh*	 *see*	 *sah*	 *saw*	 *soo*	 *soh*	 *say*

7 n row — ꕞ

 *neh*	 *nee*	 *nah*	 *naw*	 *noo*	 *noh*	 *nay*

Read each row from left to right: ɛ, i, a, ɔ, u, o, e — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Liberia and Sierra Leone on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Vai spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Vai is spoken inside the dashed area, around Robertsport in Liberia and Pujehun in Sierra Leone, close to the Atlantic coast.

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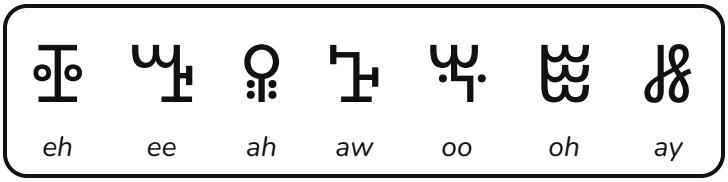
The Vowels 𖬀

ɛ, i, a, ɔ, u, o, e

Vai is written in its **own script**, from **left to right**. Each sign is a whole **syllable**: one sign says *ba*, another says *ki*.

Seven vowels

Vai has seven vowels. Here they are on their own, in the order of the Vai chart:



ɛ (eh) · i (ee) · a (ah) · ɔ (aw) · u (oo) · o (oh) · e (ay)

A big chart of syllables

The full Vai chart has about **200 signs**: a row for each consonant (b, t, k, l, m, s, n, f, g, j …) and a column for each vowel, plus signs for nasal sounds like *an*. This book teaches the **7 vowels and 7 common rows** — 56 syllables — one row at a time.

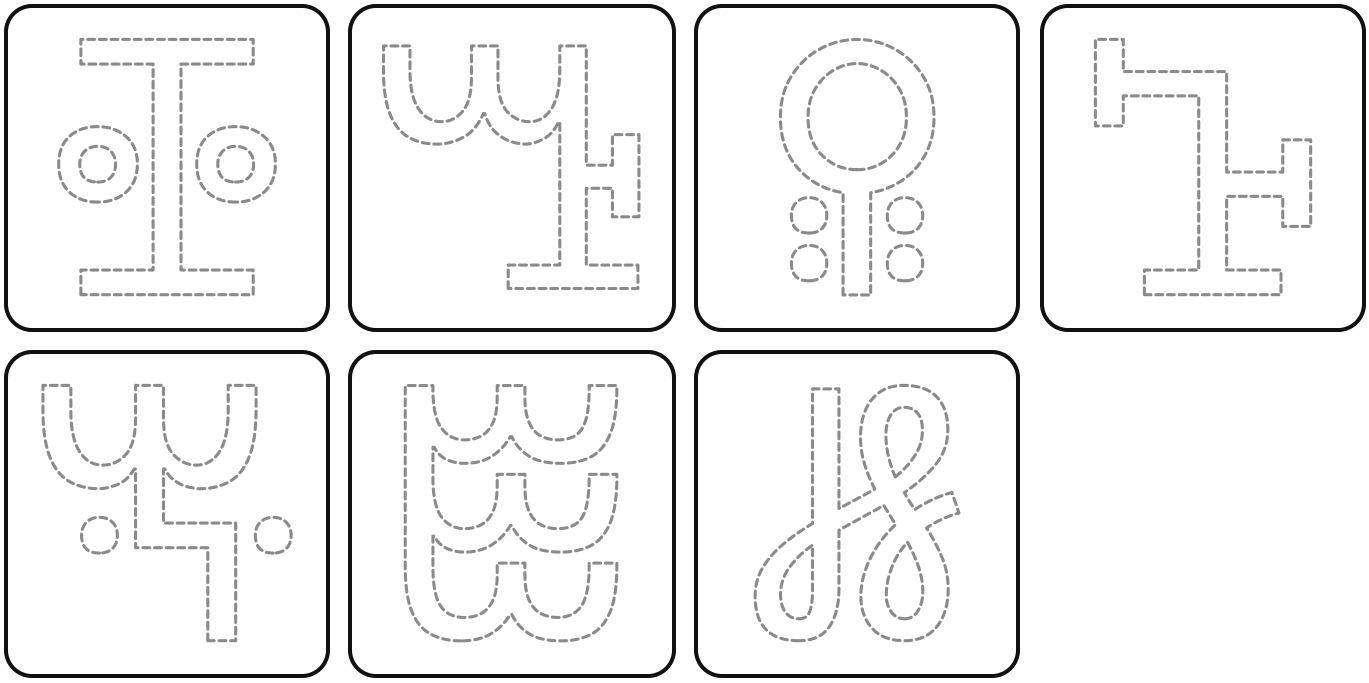
Tunes in the voice

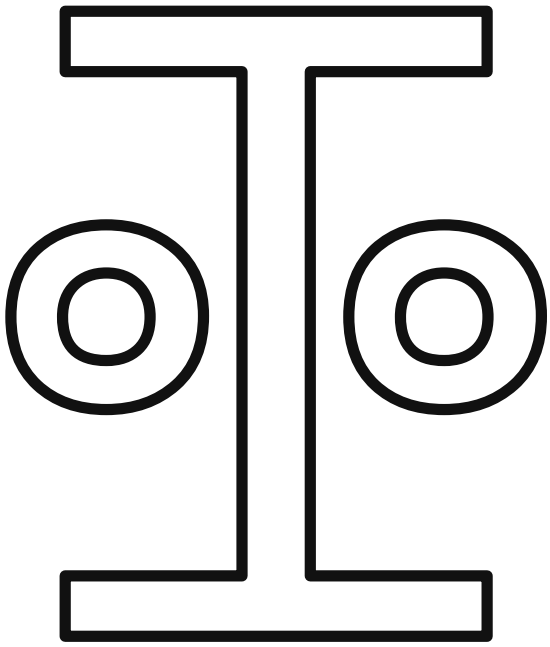
Vai is a **tone language**: a high or low voice can change a word's meaning. The script does not mark tones, so readers use the sense of the sentence.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

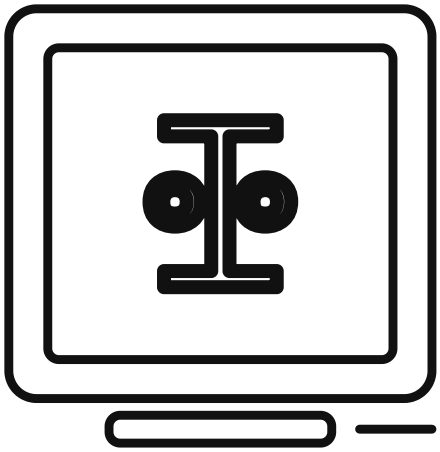
‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ ꖝ ꖞ ꖟ ꖠ ꖡ

the vowel column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

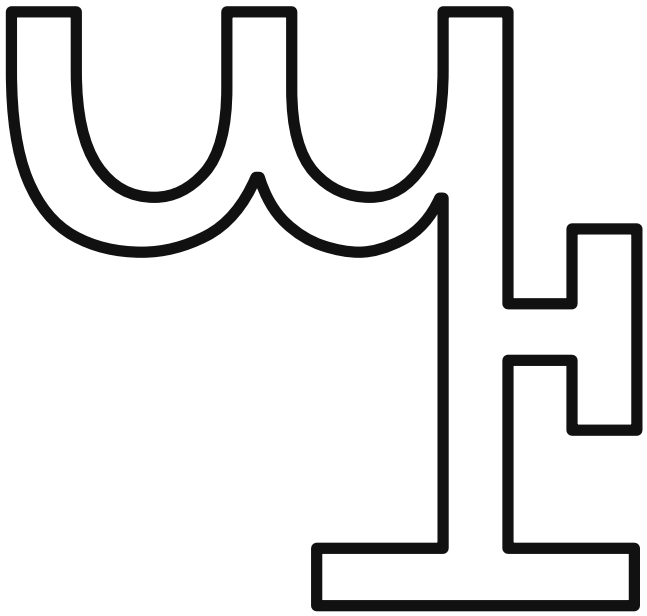
eh

say it: “eh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬴

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

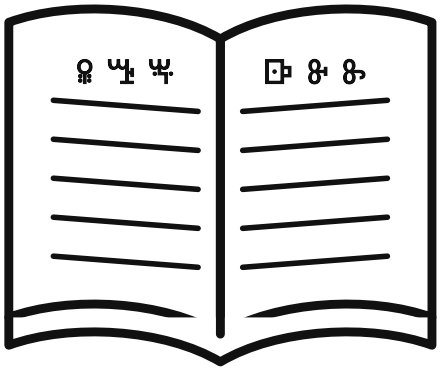
‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬰 𖬴 𖬵 𖬶 𖬷 𖬸 𖬹

the vowel column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **i**

Find 𖬴 at the end of 𖬇𖬴!



𖬴 IS FOR

𖬇𖬴

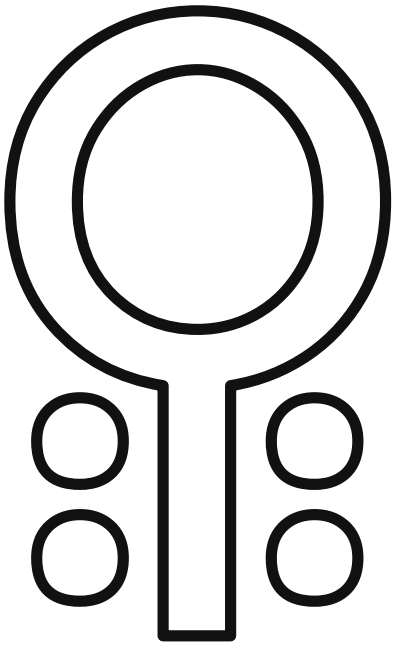
VAH-ee

Vai — the name of the language and its people

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬇𖬴

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ah

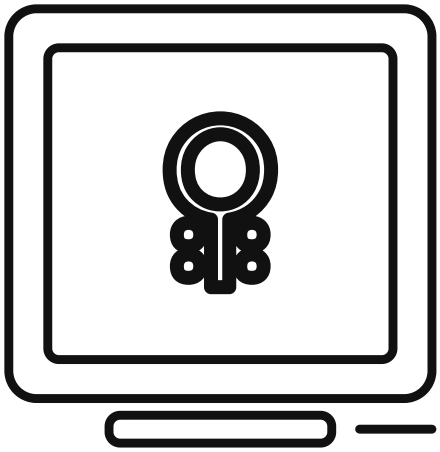
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

the vowel column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **a**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

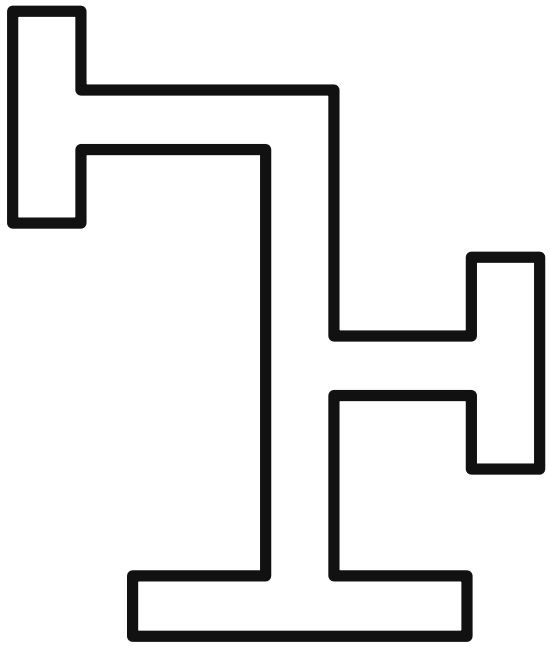
ah

say it: “ah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕳ

aw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

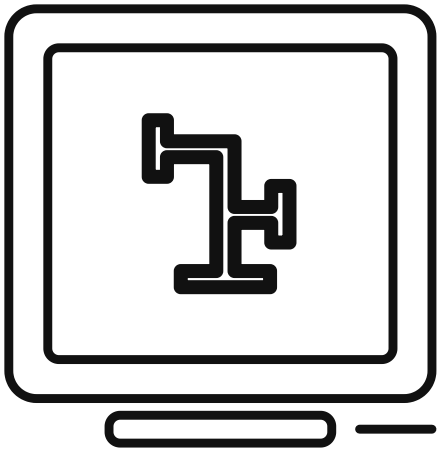
‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꔰ ꔱ ꔲ ꕳ ꔴ ꔵ ꔶ

the vowel column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕳ IS FOR

ꕳ

aw

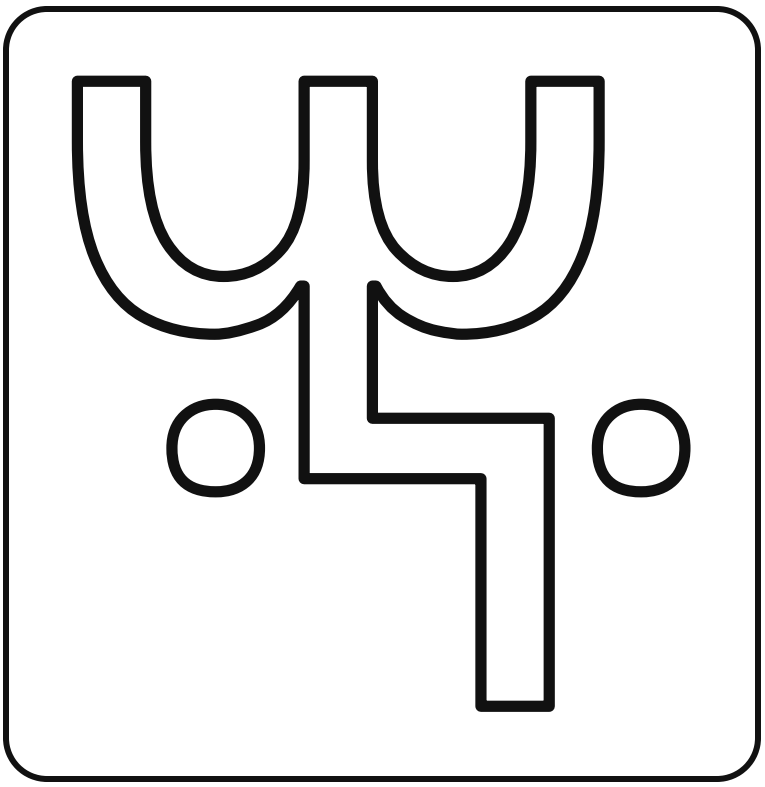
say it: “aw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꔵꕳ

ꔵꕳ ꔵꕳ ꔵꕳ ꔵꕳ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬲

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

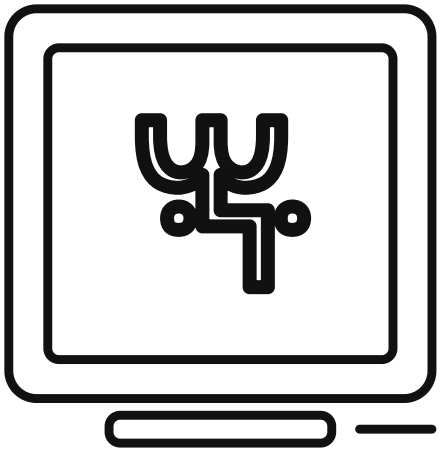
‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬰 𖬱 𖬲 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬶

the vowel column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **u**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬲 IS FOR

𖬲

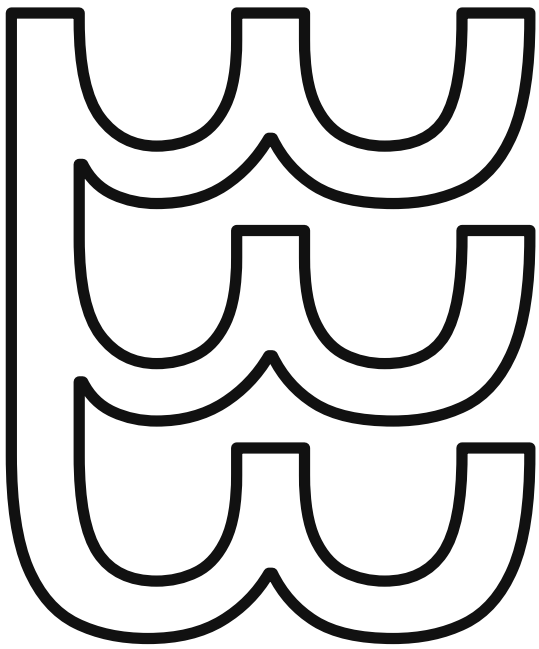
oo

say it: “oo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬲

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NAME · ITS SOUND

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

the vowel column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **o**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

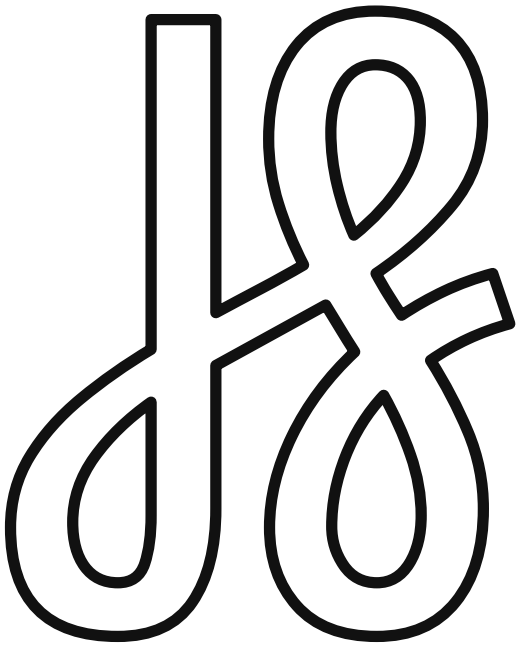
oh

say it: “oh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬀

ay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

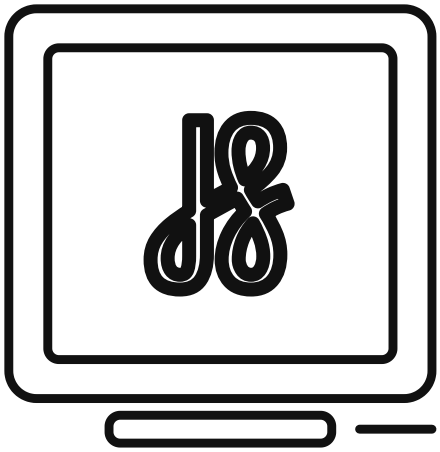
‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬰 𖬱 𖬲 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬀

the vowel column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **e**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬀 IS FOR

𖬀

ay

say it: “ay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬱𖬴

𖬀 𖬀 𖬀 𖬀

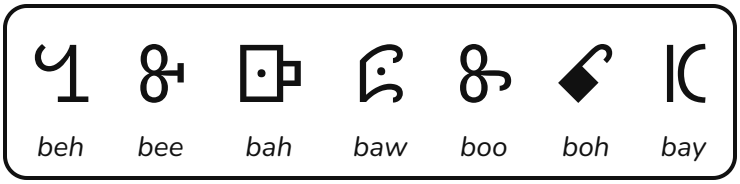
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ROW B

The B Row

bɛ, bi, ba, bɔ, bu, bo, be

Every syllable in this row starts with **b**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

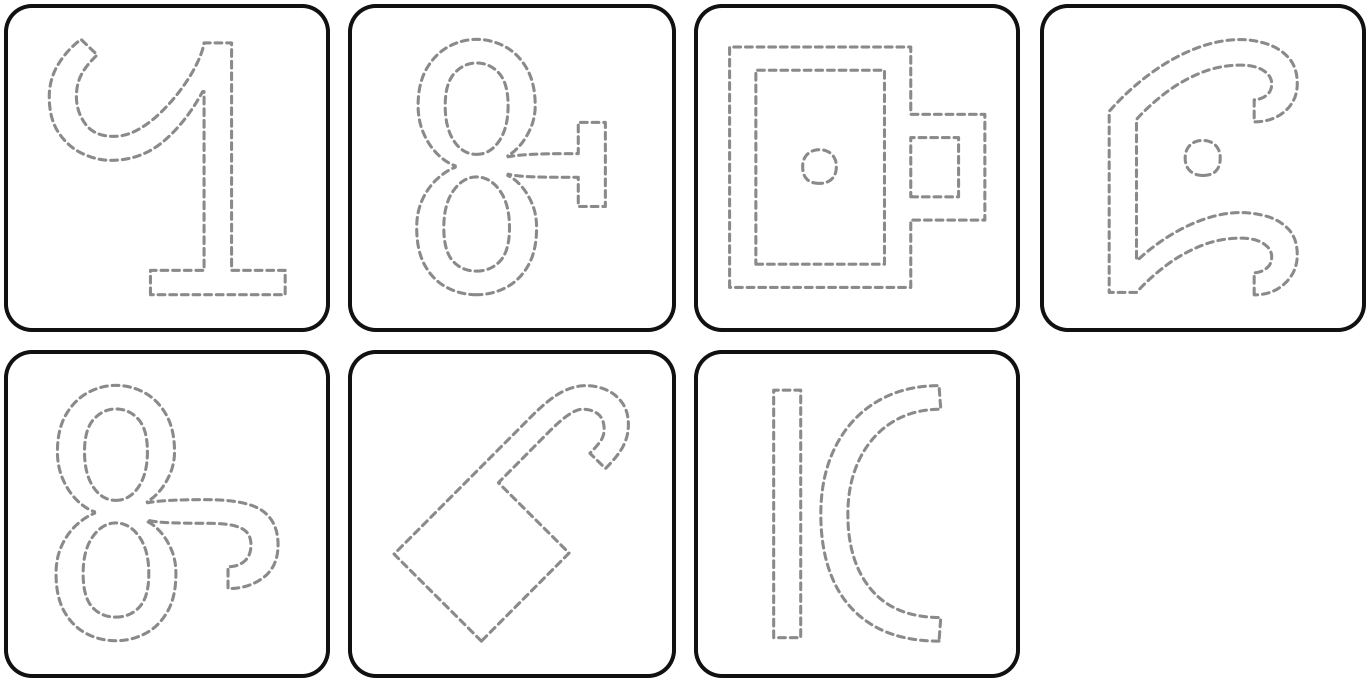


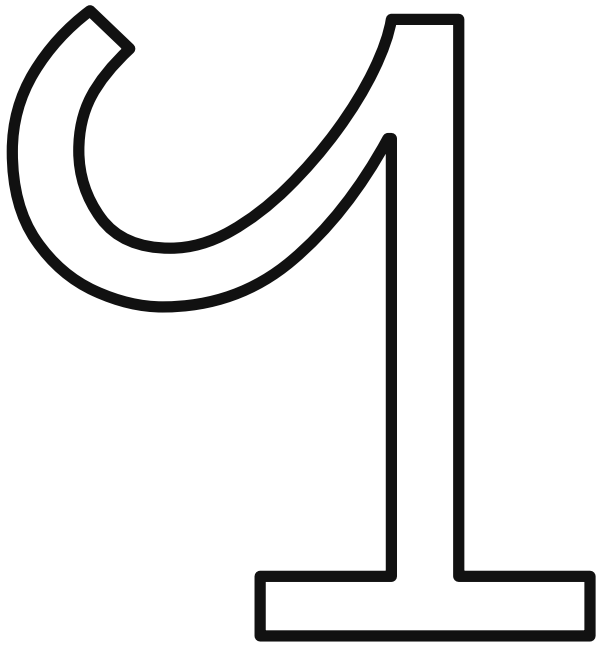
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the b row

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕉ

beh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꕉ ꕖ ꕗ ꕘ ꕙ ꕚ ꕛ

row **b** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **bɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕉ IS FOR

ꕉ

beh

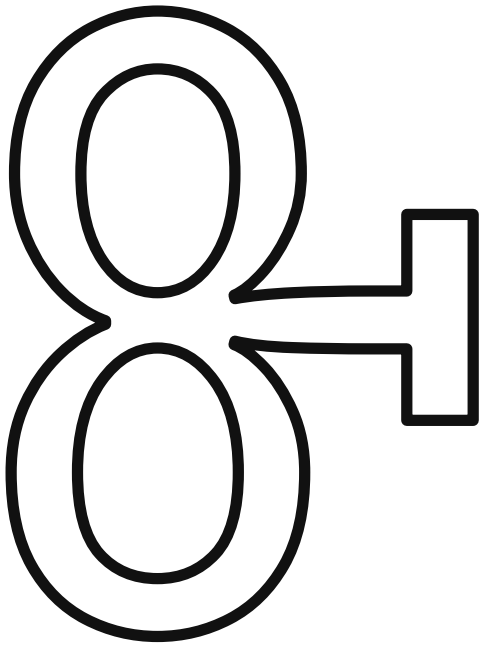
say it: “beh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕉ

ꕉ ꕉ ꕉ ꕉ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕤ

bee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

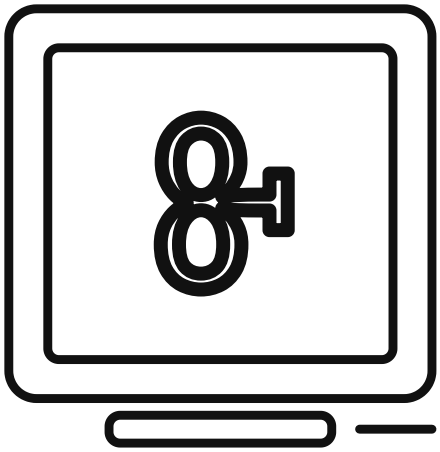
‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꔷ ꕤ ꕥ ꕦ ꕧ ꕨ ꕩ

row **b** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **bi**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕤ IS FOR

ꕤ

bee

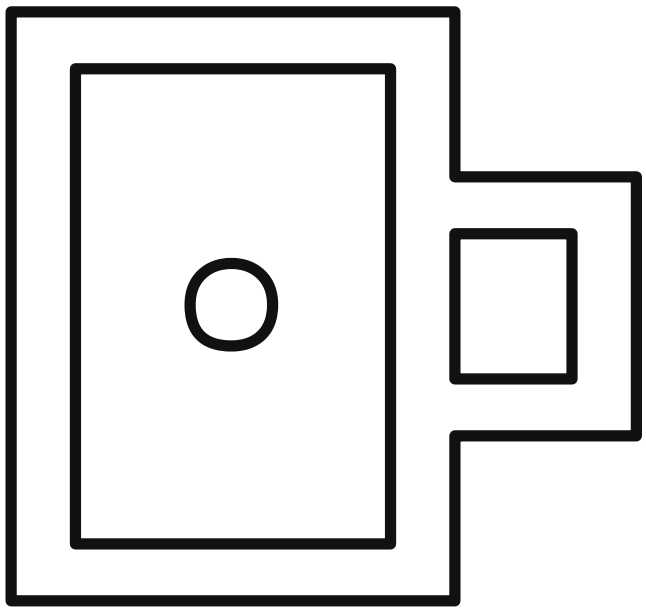
say it: “bee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕤꔷ

ꕤ ꕤ ꕤ ꕤ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

bah

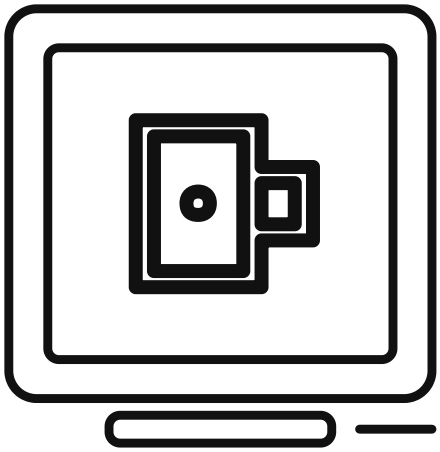
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **b** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ba**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

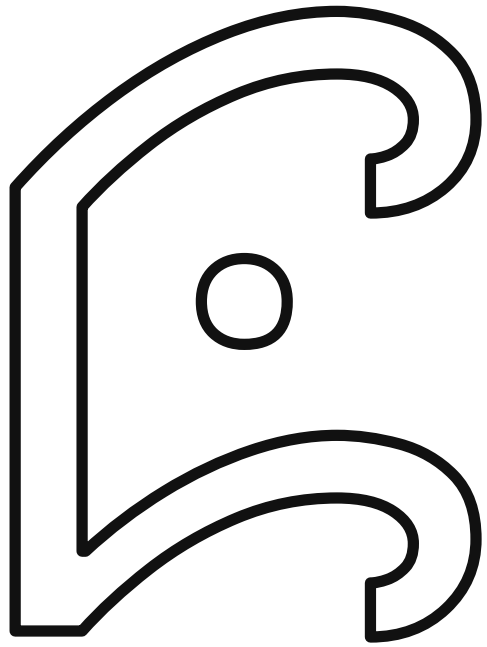
bah

say it: “bah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

baw

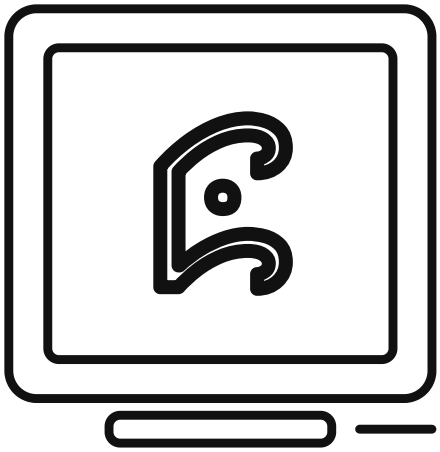
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **b** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **bɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

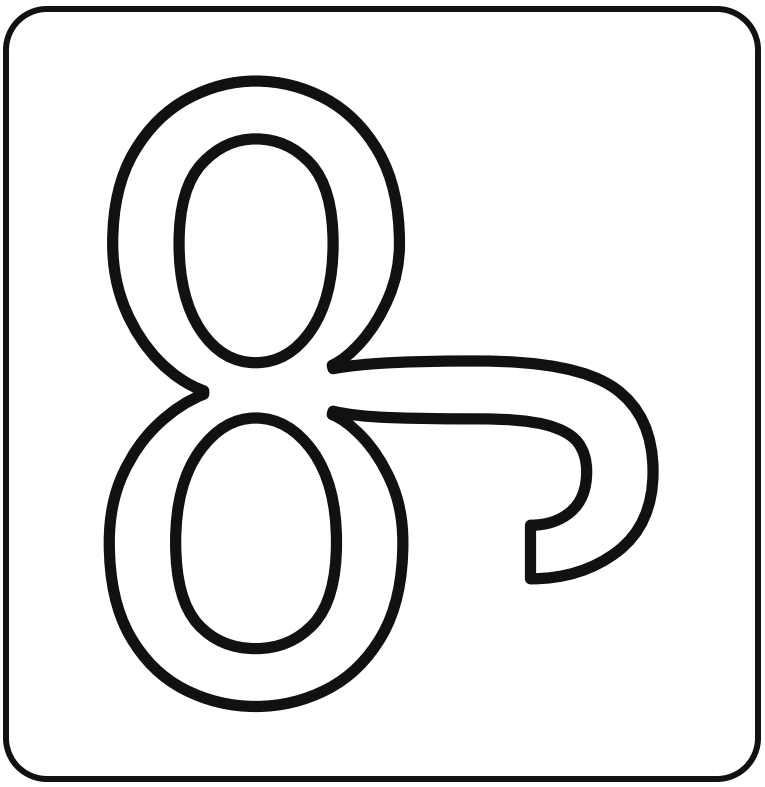
baw

say it: “baw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖆ

boo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

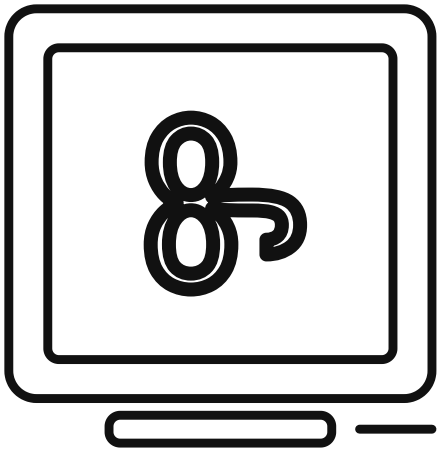
‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ ꖆ ꖢ ꖤ ꖆ ꖥ ꖞ

row **b** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **bu**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖆ IS FOR

ꖆ

boo

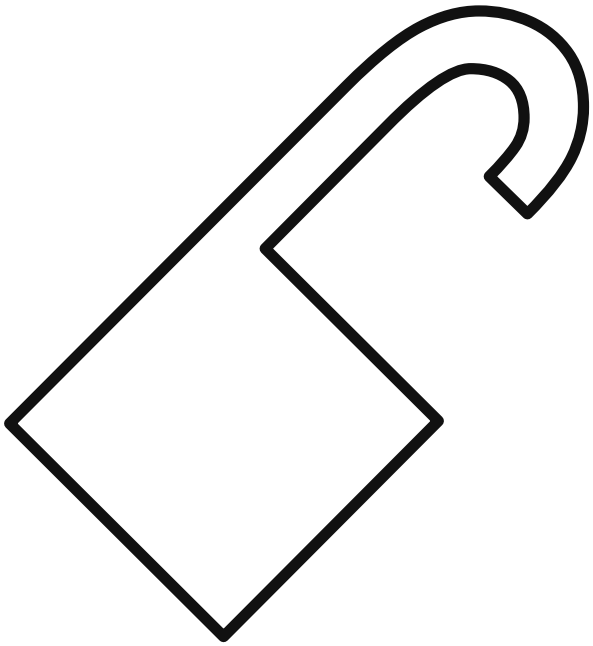
say it: “boo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜꖆ

ꖆ ꖆ ꖆ ꖆ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

boh

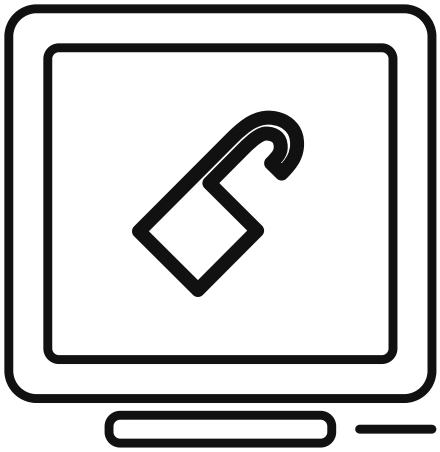
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **b** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **bo**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

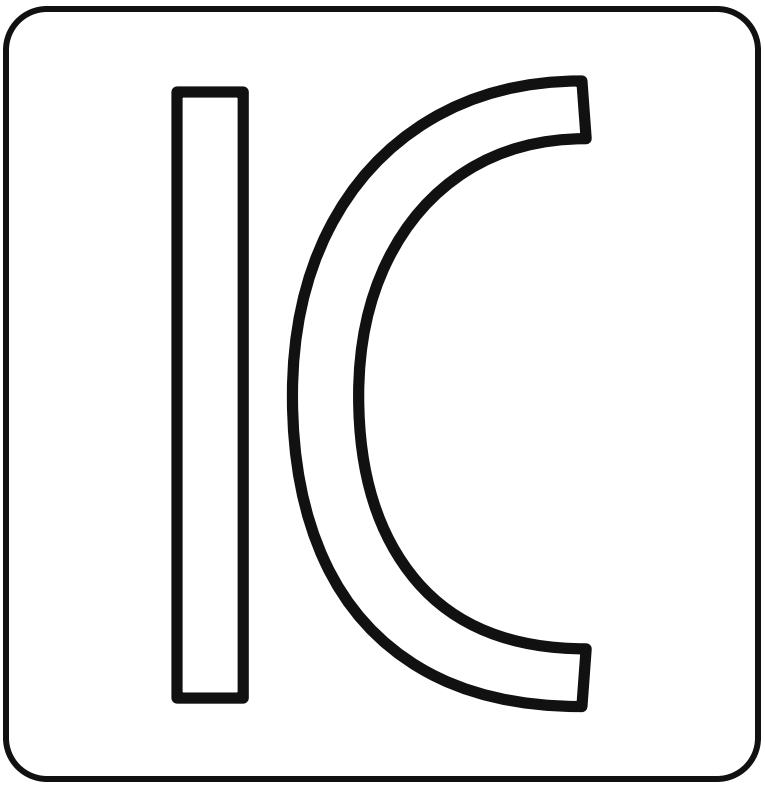
boh

say it: “boh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

bay

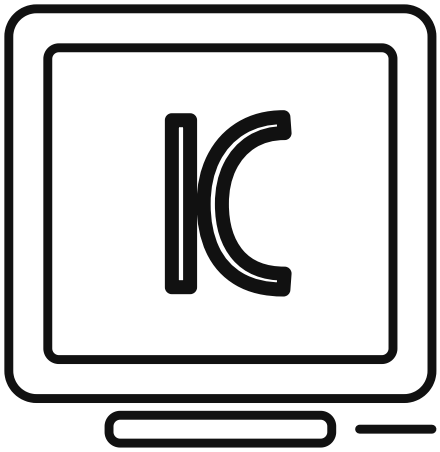
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **b** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **be**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

bay

say it: “bay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

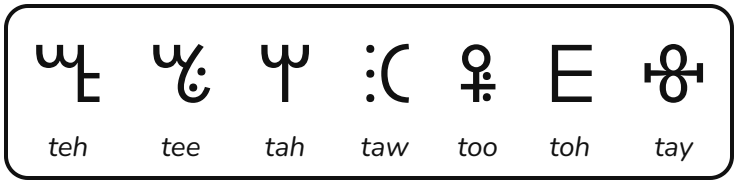
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ROW T

The T Row 𐤕

tɛ, ti, ta, tɔ, tu, to, te

Every syllable in this row starts with **t**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

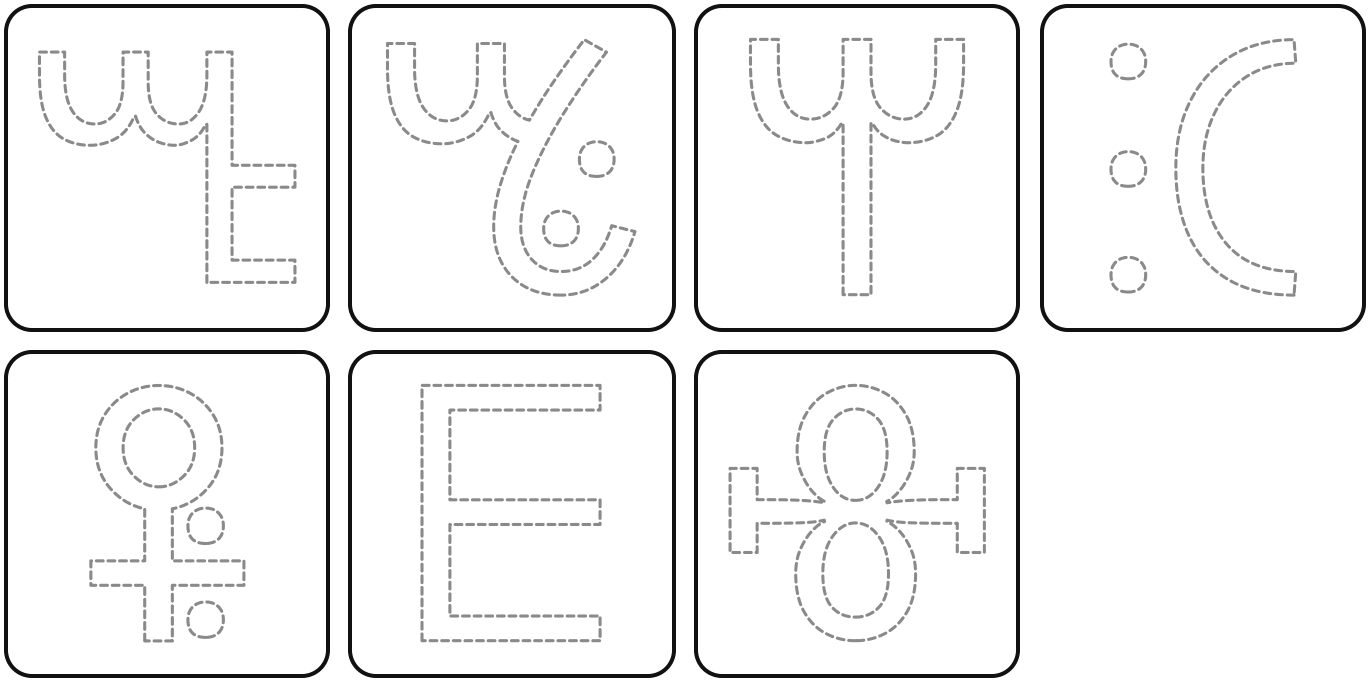


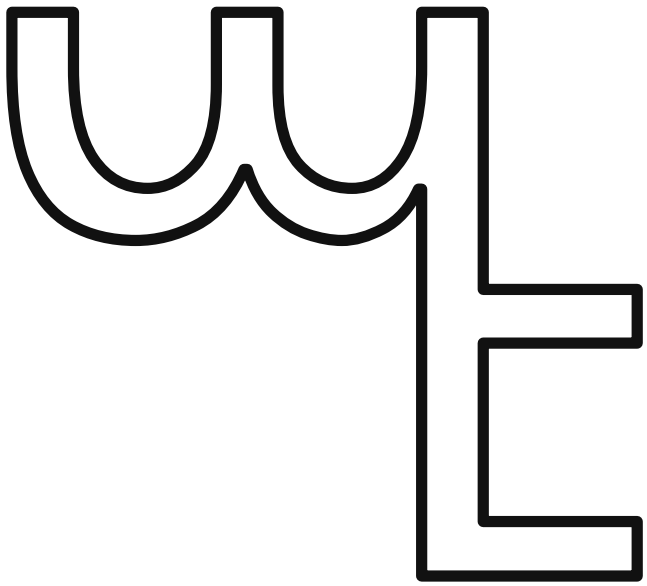
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the t row ፕ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕉꕮ

teh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

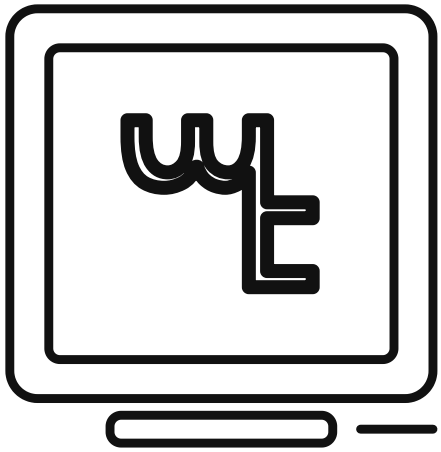
‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꕉꕮ ꕊꕮ ꕌꕮ ꕍꕮ ꕎꕮ ꕏꕮ

row **t** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **tɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕉꕮ IS FOR

ꕉꕮ

teh

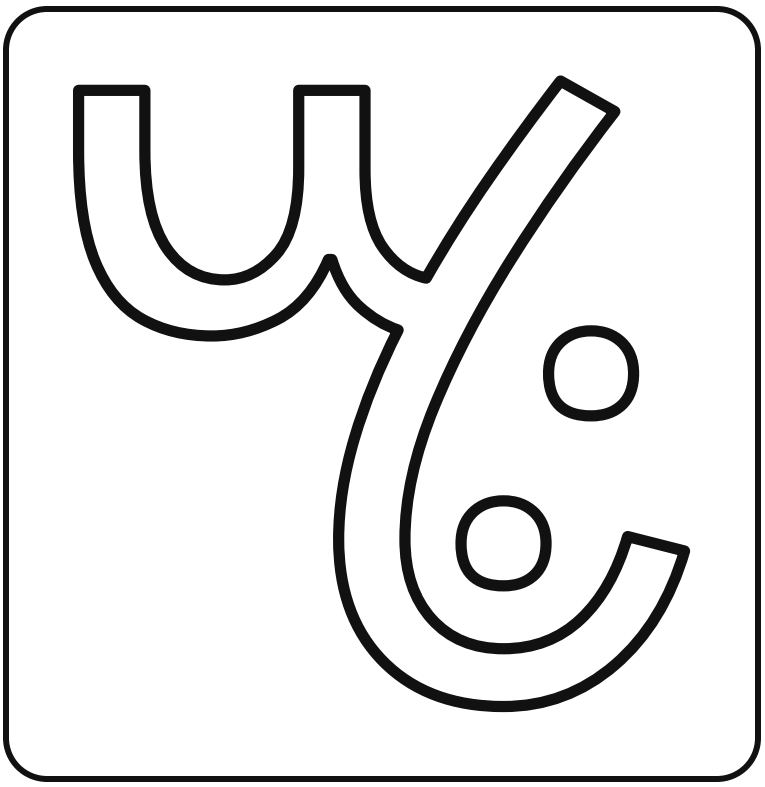
say it: “teh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕉꕮ

ꕉꕮ ꕉꕮ ꕉꕮ ꕉꕮ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬁

tee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬄 𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 𖬅 𖬆

row **t** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ti**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬁 IS FOR

𖬁

tee

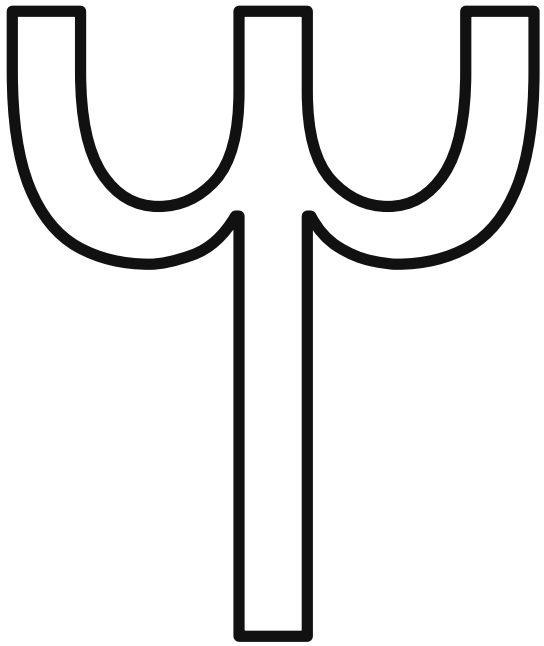
say it: “tee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬁𖬁

𖬁 𖬁 𖬁 𖬁

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

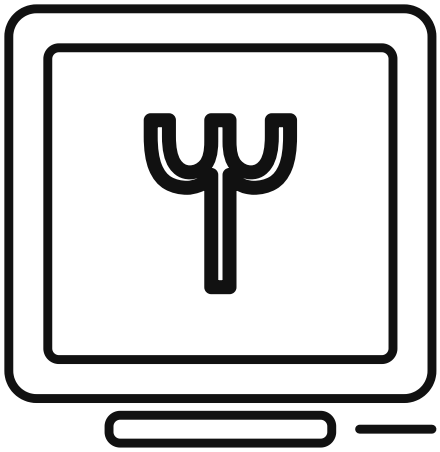
‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖛ ꖝ ꖜ ꖞ ꖟ ꖠ ꖡ

row **t** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ta**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

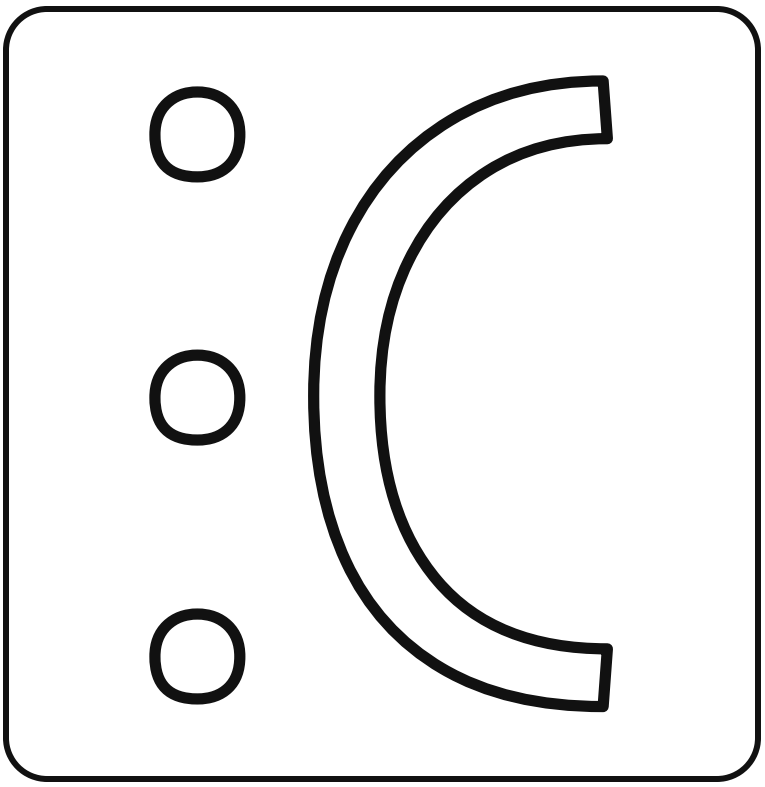
tah

say it: “tah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖛꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

꘠

taw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

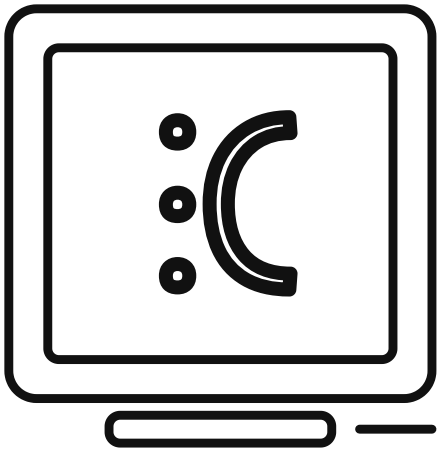
‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ ꖞ ꖟ [꘠] ꖡ ꖢ ꖣ

row **t** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **tɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



꘠ IS FOR

꘠

taw

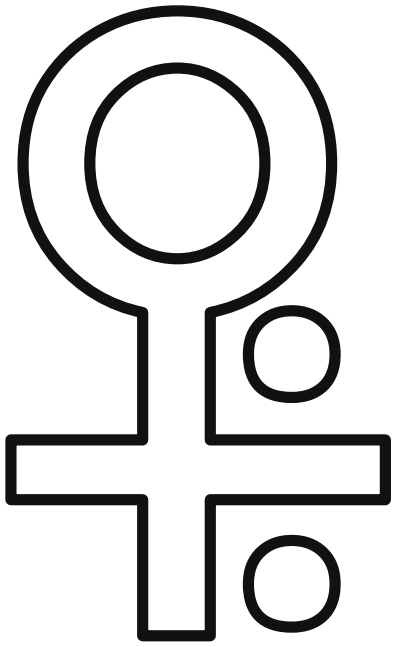
say it: “taw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜ

꘠ ꘠ ꘠ ꘠

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬲

too

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

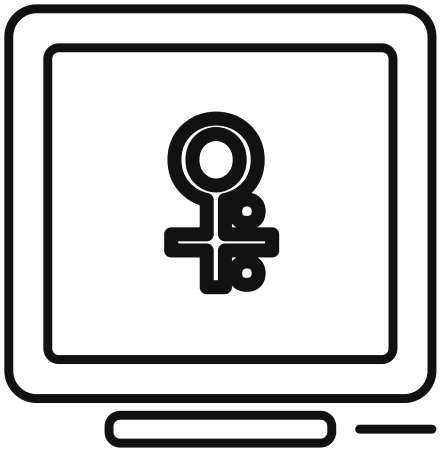
‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬱 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬲 𖬶 𖬷

row **t** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **tu**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬲 IS FOR

𖬲

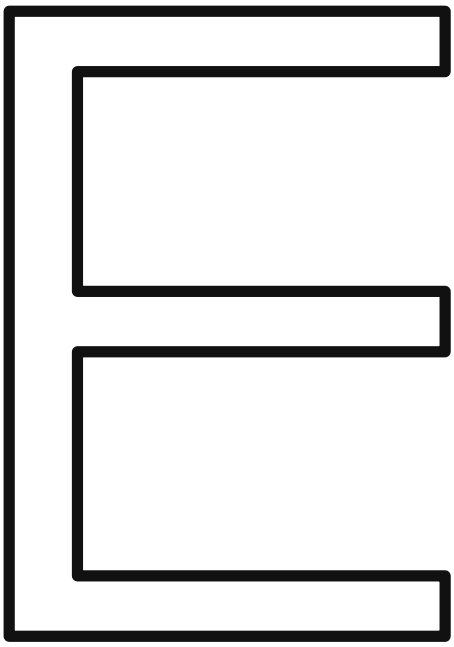
too

say it: “too”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬱𖬲

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NAME · ITS SOUND

E

toh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

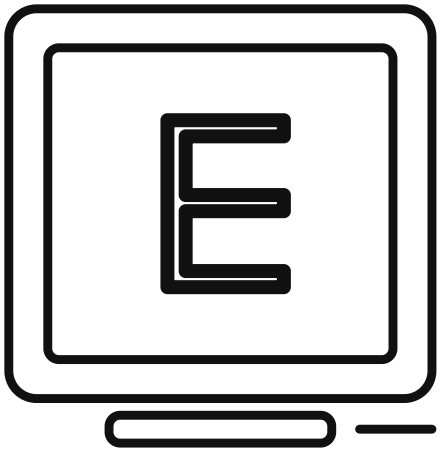
‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ ꖝ ꖞ ꖟ ꖠ **E** ꖢ

row **t** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **to**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



E IS FOR

E

toh

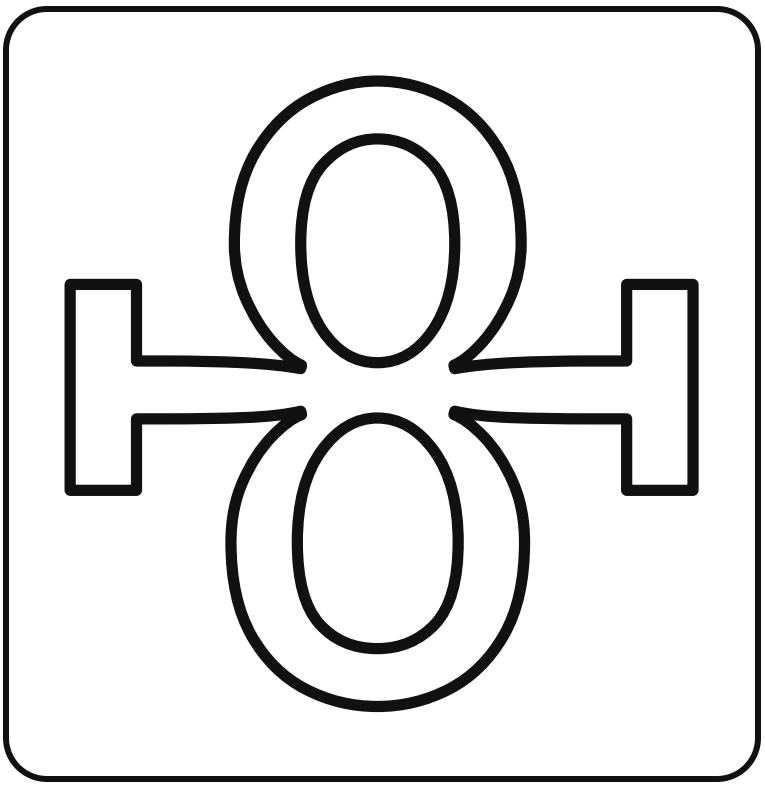
say it: “toh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜ

E E E E

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NAME · ITS SOUND

tay

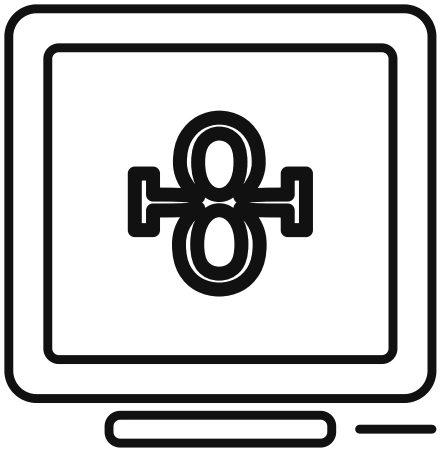
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **t** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **te**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

tay

say it: “tay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

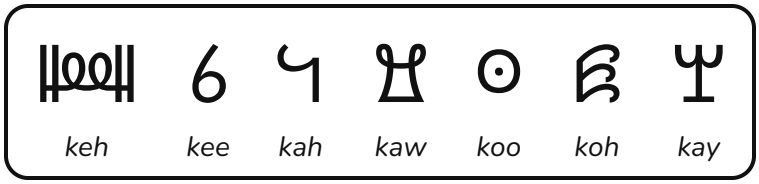
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ROW K

The K Row ᓀ

kɛ, ki, ka, kɔ, ku, ko, ke

Every syllable in this row starts with **k**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

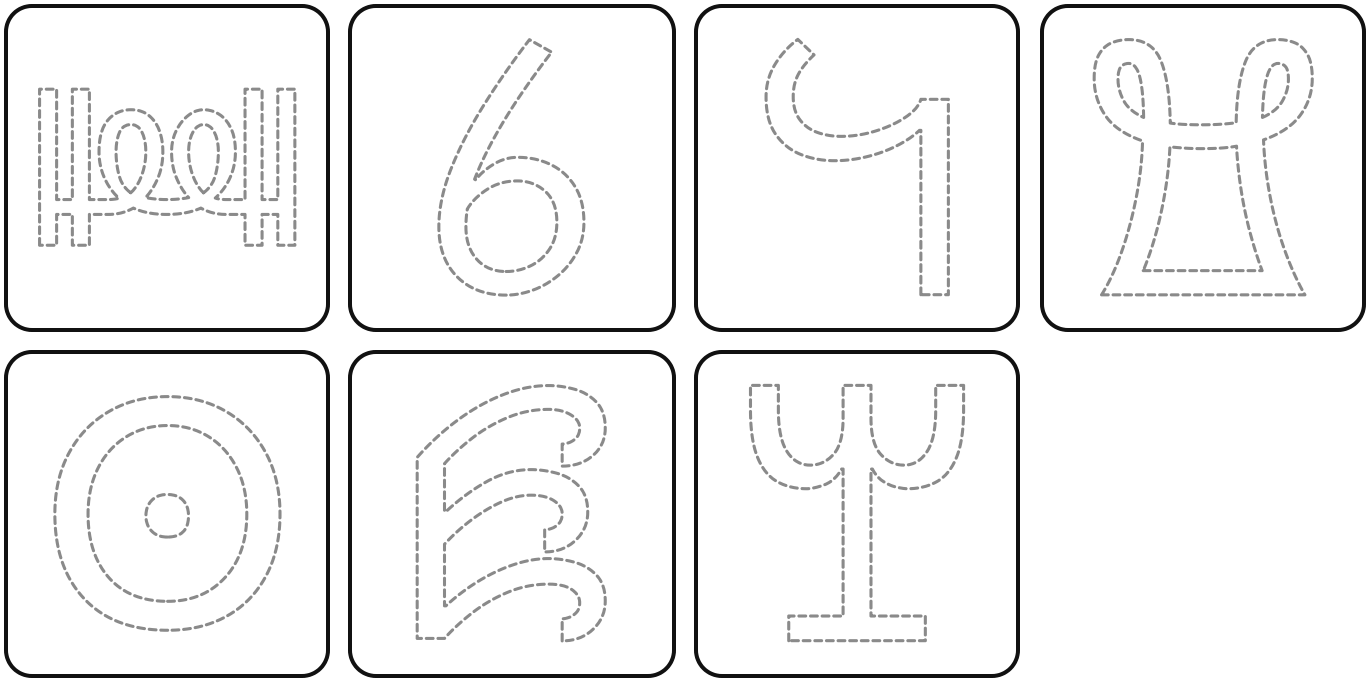


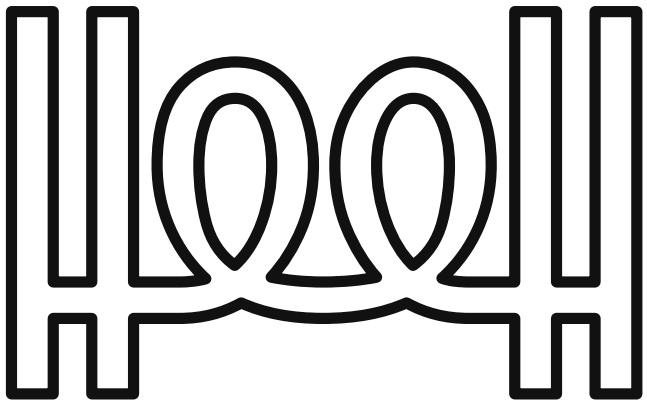
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the k row ካ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND



keh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

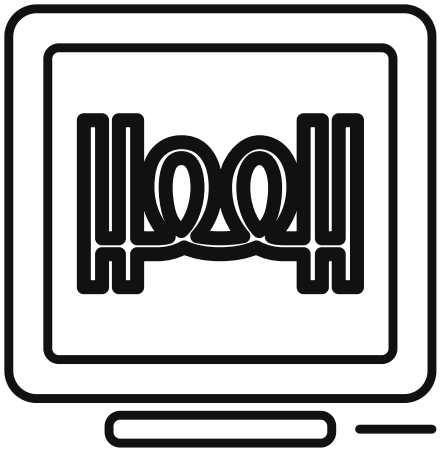
‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART



row **k** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **kɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



** IS FOR**



keh

say it: “keh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · **



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NAME · ITS SOUND

6

kee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬀 6 𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅

row **k** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ki**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



6 IS FOR

6

kee

say it: “kee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬅𖬄

6 6 6 6

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ꕉ

NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕉ

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

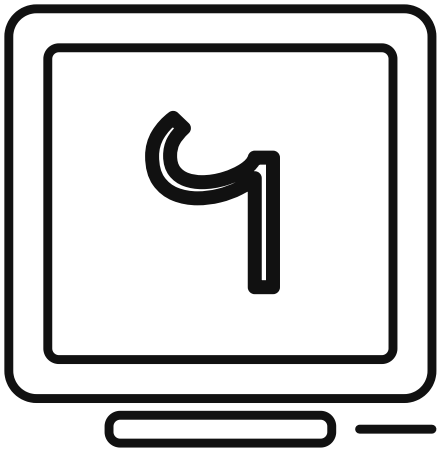
‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜꖛ ꕀ ꕉ ꕊ ꕋ ꕌ ꕍ

row **k** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ka**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕉ IS FOR

ꕉ

kah

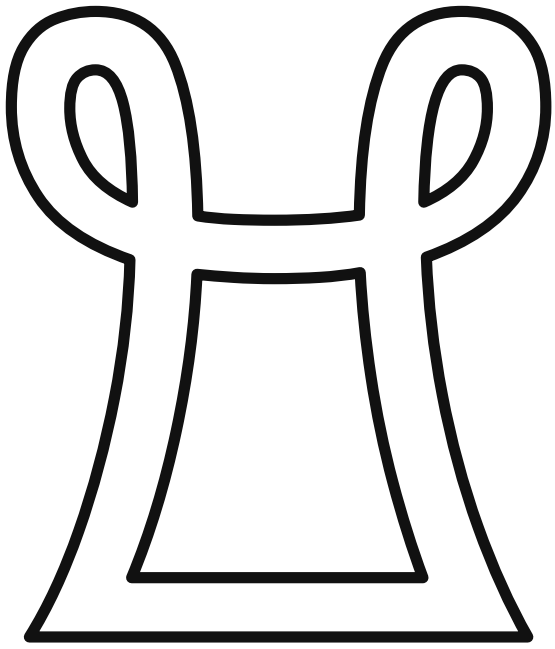
say it: “kah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕉꕊ

ꕉ ꕉ ꕉ ꕉ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

kaw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **k** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **kɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

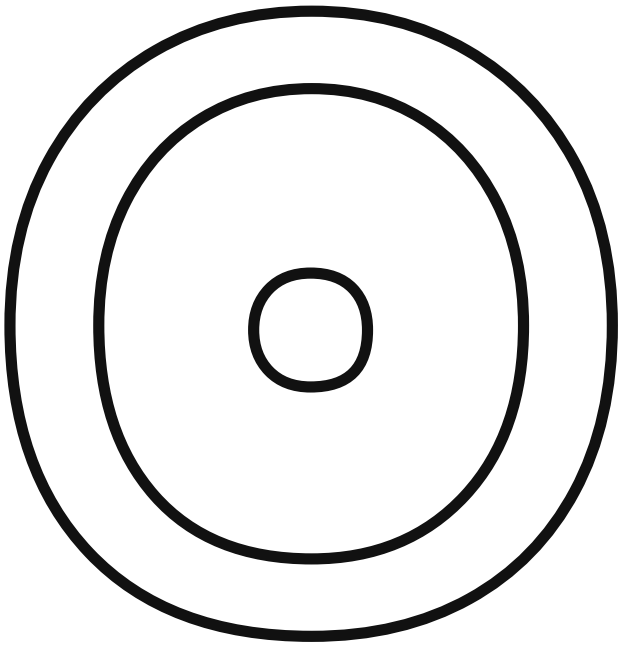
kaw

say it: “kaw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

koo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

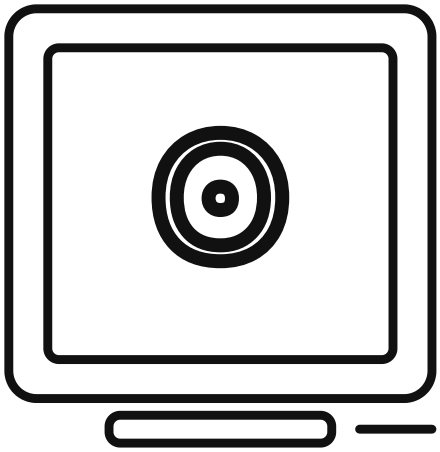
‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖬ ꖭ ꖮ ꖯ ꖜ ꖰ ꖱ

row **k** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ku**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

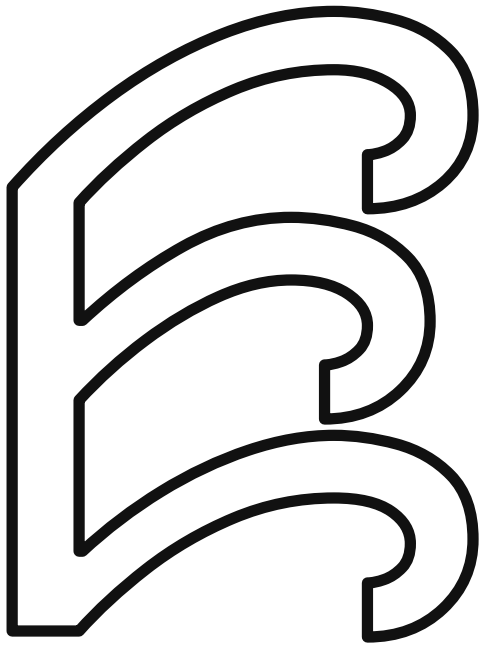
koo

say it: “koo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖱ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

koh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **k** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ko**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

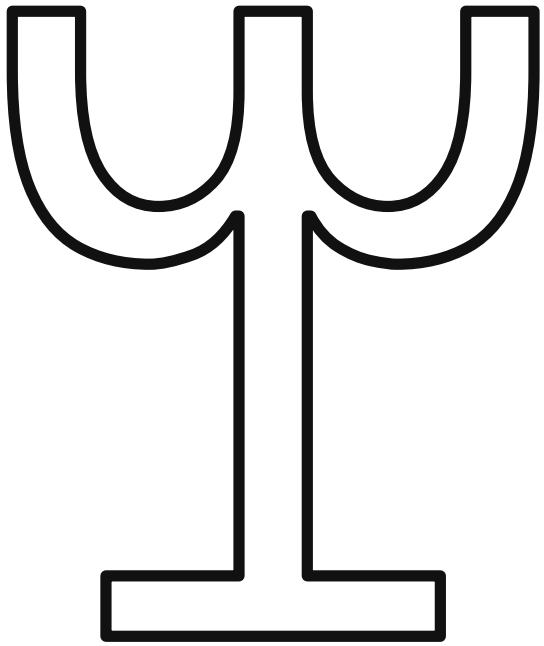
koh

say it: “koh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꔪ

kay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

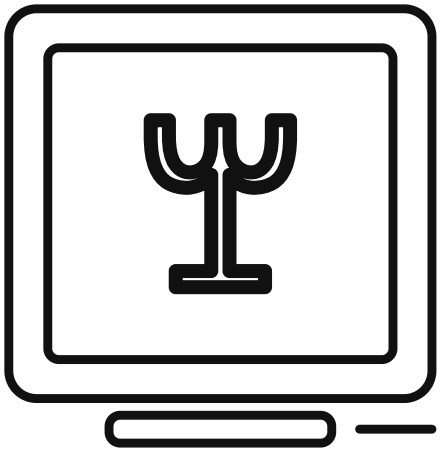
‘k’ as in “kite”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜꖜ ꕷ ꕹ ꕢ ꕯ ꕤ ꔪ

row **k** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ke**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꔪ IS FOR

ꔪ

kay

say it: “kay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕹꔪ

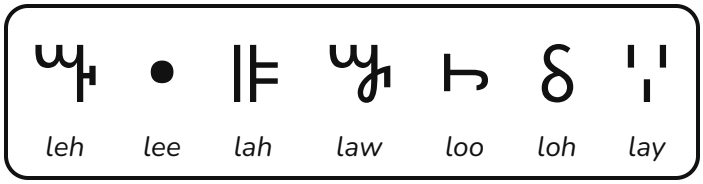
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ROW L

The L Row ᛚ

lɛ, li, la, lɔ, lu, lo, le

Every syllable in this row starts with **l**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

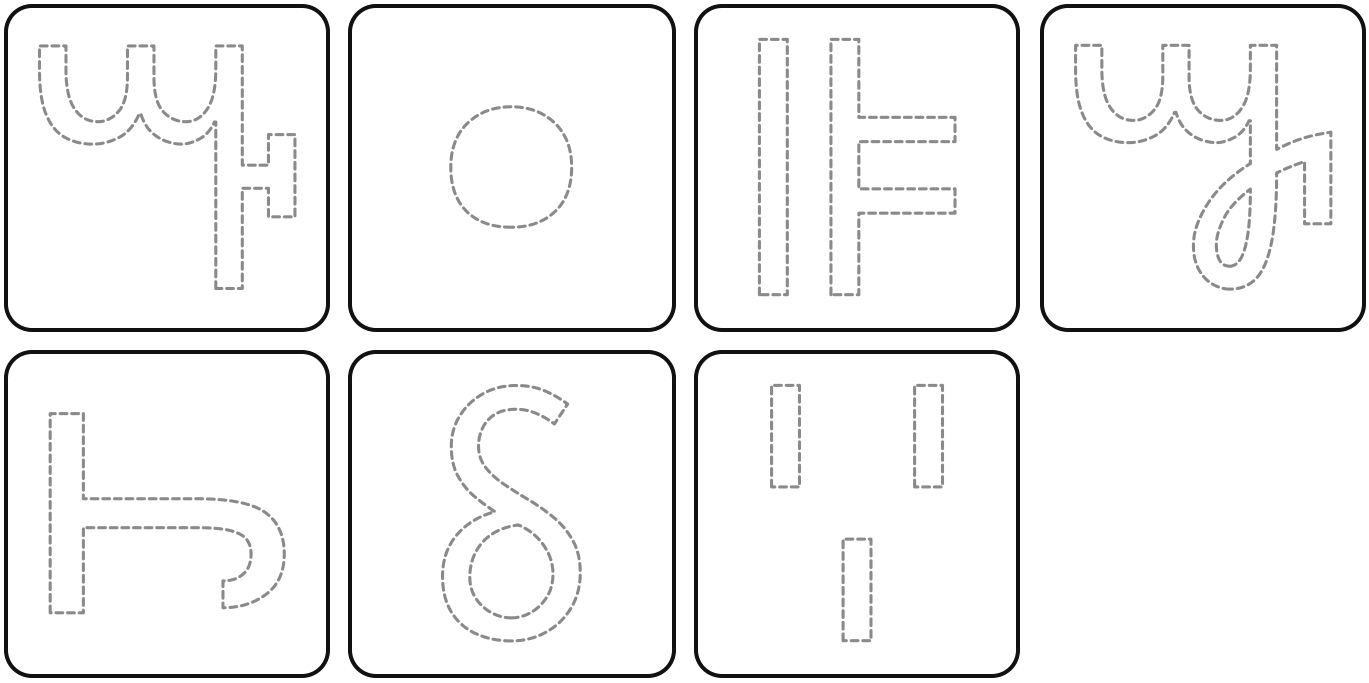


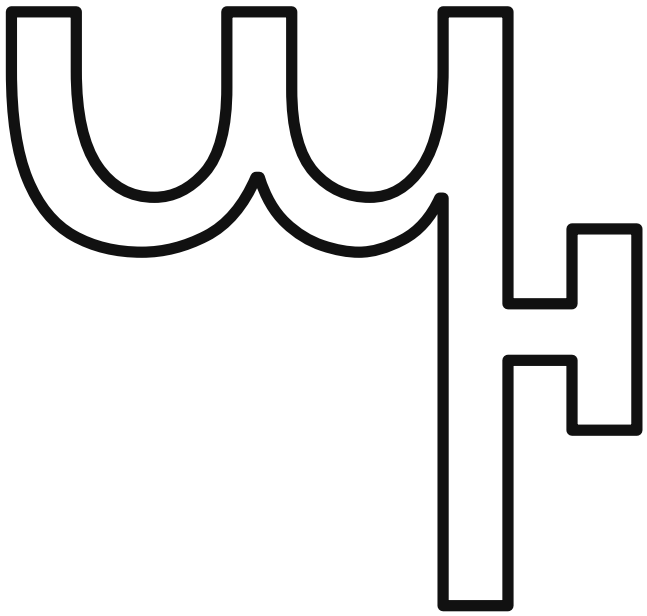
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the ו row וֹ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

leh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꕯ ꖜ ꖆ ꕤ ꘎

row **l** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **lɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

leh

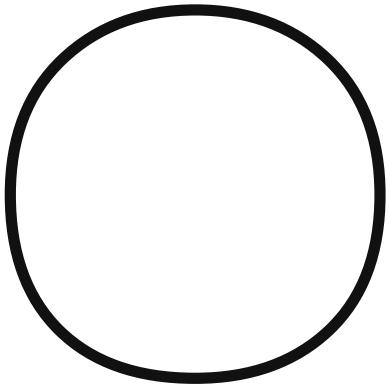
say it: “leh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕯꖜ

ꖜ ꖜ ꖜ ꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

●

lee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

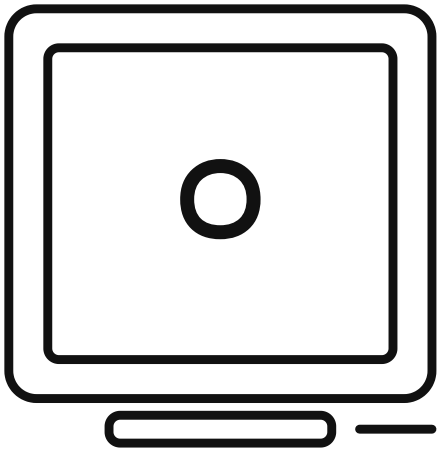
‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꖛ ꖜ ꖙ ꖘ ꖗ

row **l** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **li**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



• IS FOR

●

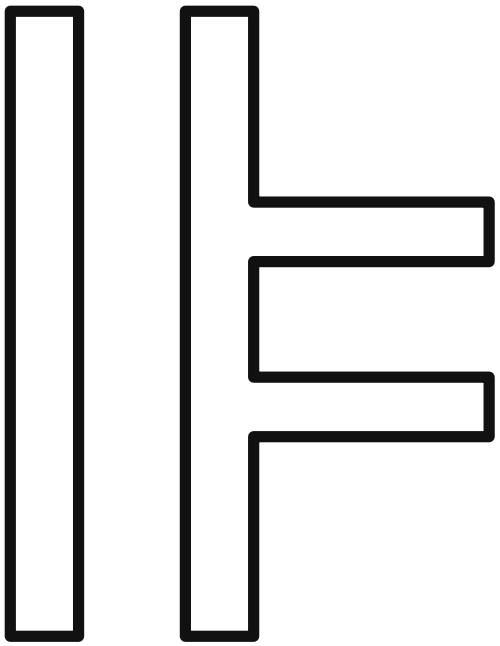
lee

say it: “lee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖬ

lah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

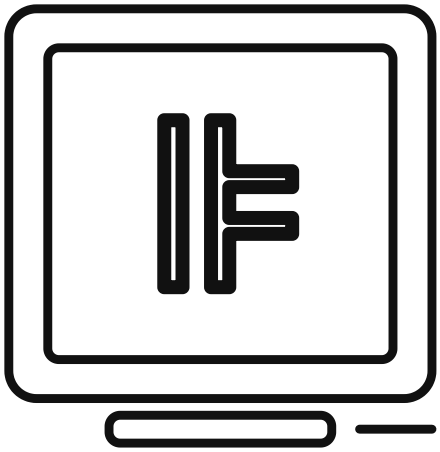
‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꖬ ꖛ ꕀ ꔹ

row **l** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **la**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖬ IS FOR

ꖬ

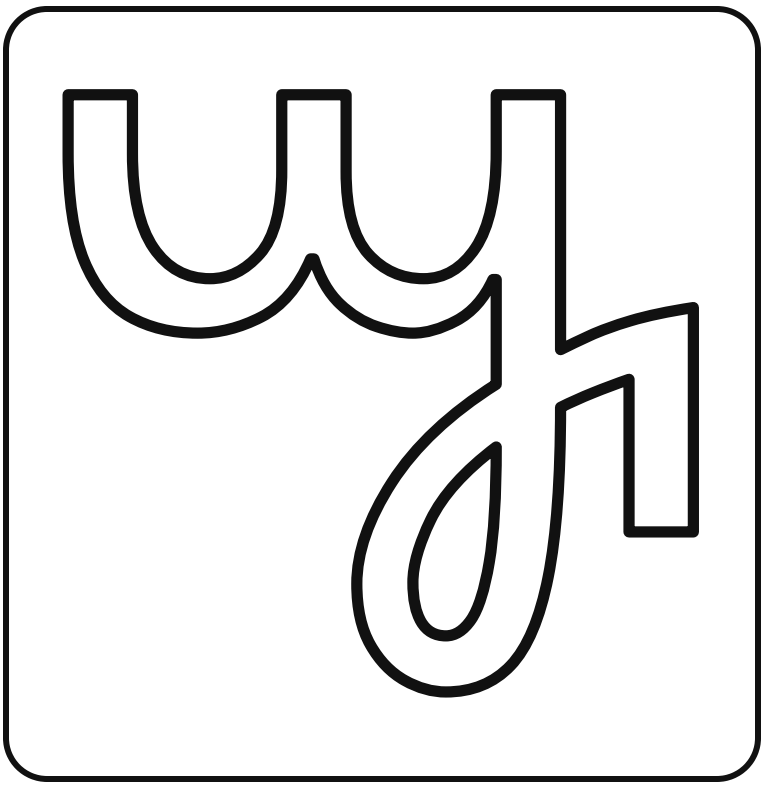
lah

say it: “lah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖜꖬ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖬ

law

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꖊ ꖬ ꖋ ꖛ ꘎

row **ꖊ** · column **ꖛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ꖊꖛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖬ IS FOR

ꖬ

law

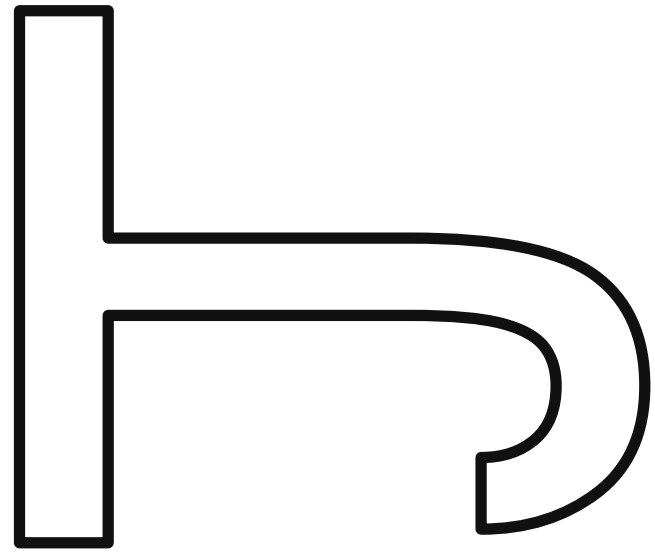
say it: “law”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖬ

ꖬ ꖬ ꖬ ꖬ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕷ

loo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

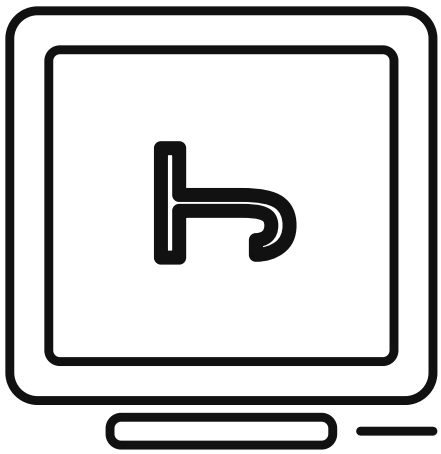
‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꖛ ꖜ ꕷ ꖘ ꘎

row **l** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **lu**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕷ IS FOR

ꕷ

loo

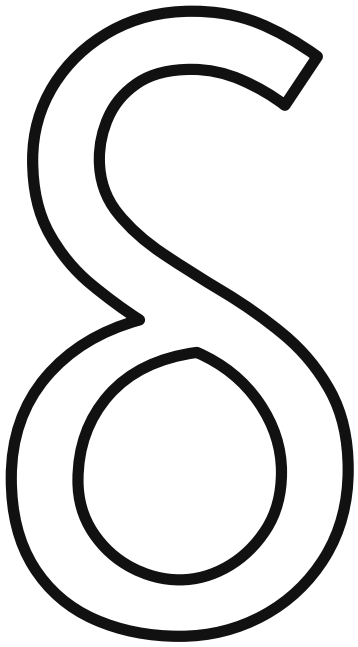
say it: “loo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕷ

ꕷ ꕷ ꕷ ꕷ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꗇ

loh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

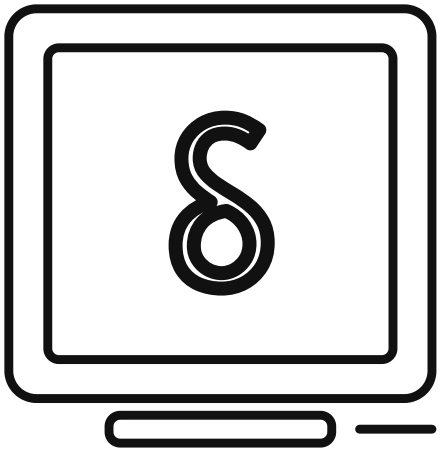
‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖜ • ꖛ ꖜ ꖚ ꗇ ꘎

row **l** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **lo**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꗇ IS FOR

ꗇ

loh

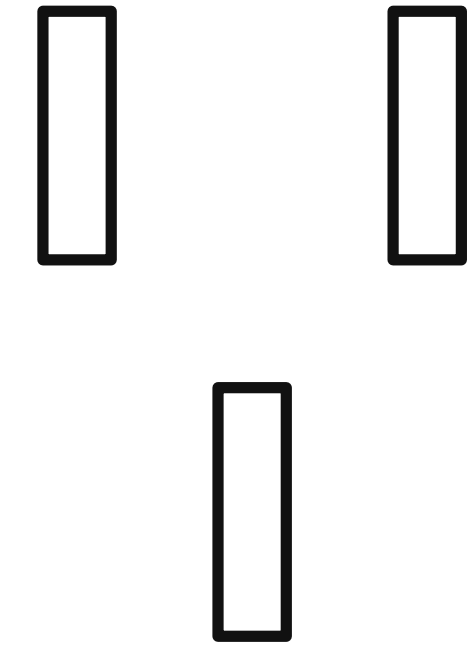
say it: “loh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕉꕢ

ꗇ ꗇ ꗇ ꗇ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

lay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

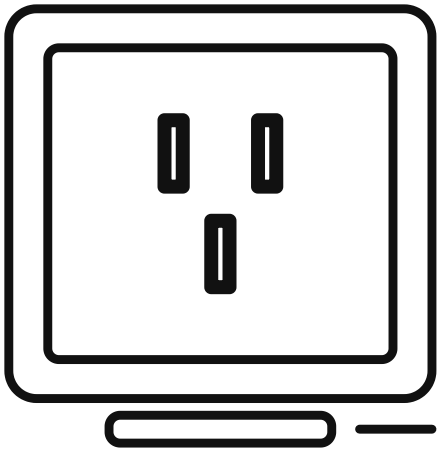
‘l’ as in “lamp”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꕳ • ꔰ ꕳ ꔷ ꕢ ꖜ

row **l** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **le**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

lay

say it: “lay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕳꖜ

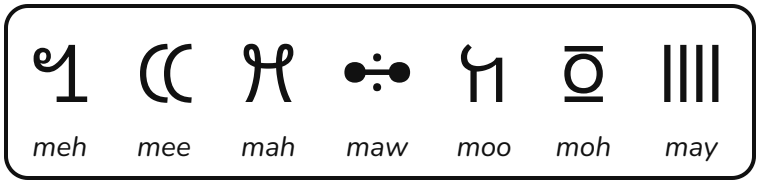
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ROW M

The M Row ᚻ

mɛ, mi, ma, mɔ, mu, mo, me

Every syllable in this row starts with **m**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:



meh *mee* *mah* *maw* *moo* *moh* *may*

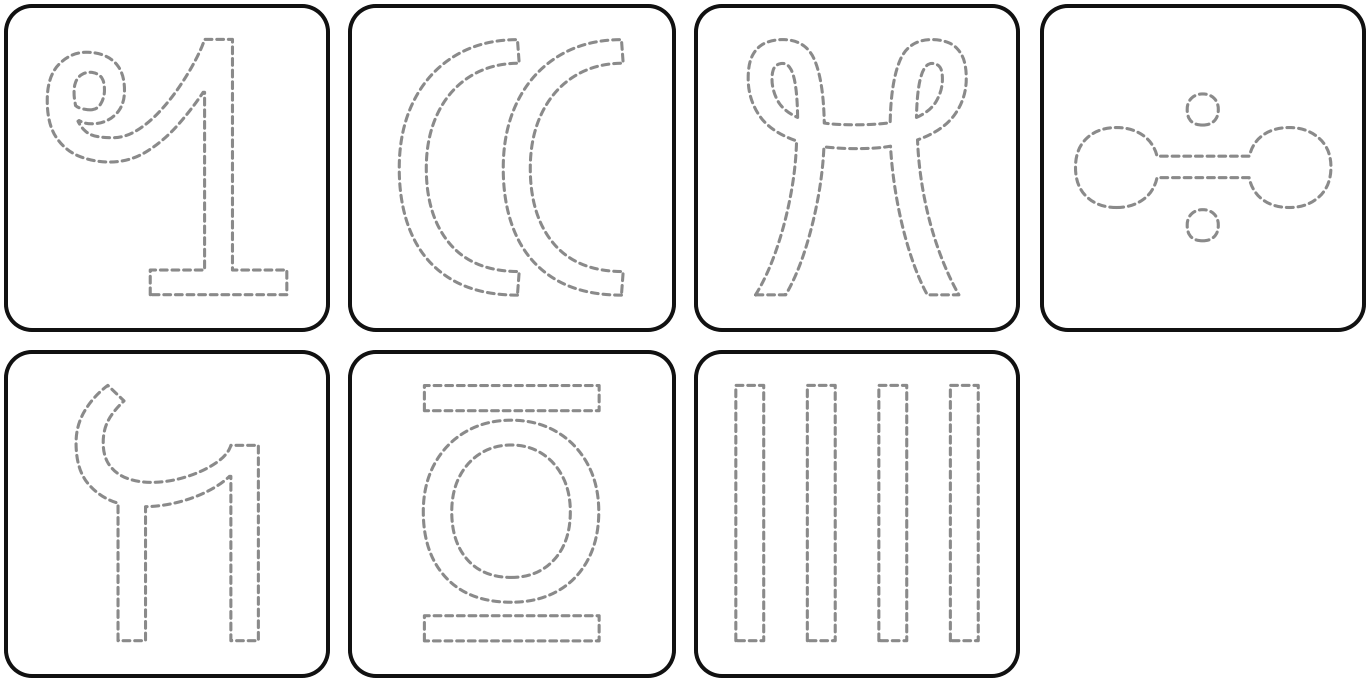
Try it

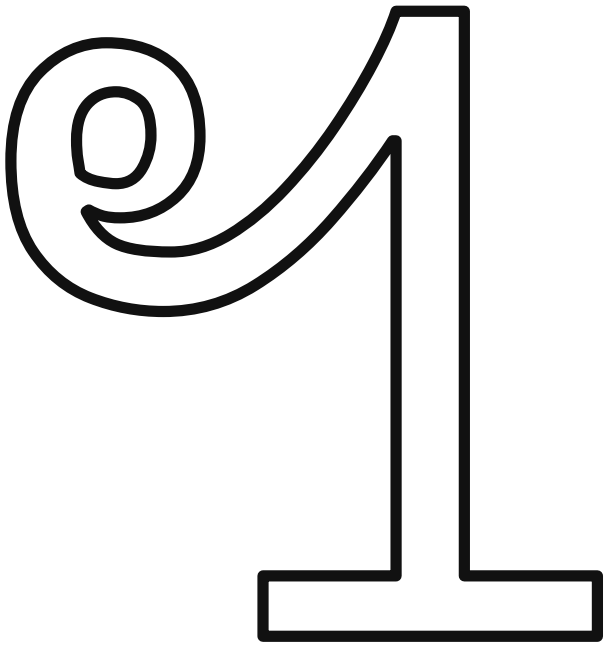
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the m row

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬁

meh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬁 𖬀 𖬂 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅 𖬆

row **m** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **mɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬁 IS FOR

𖬁

meh

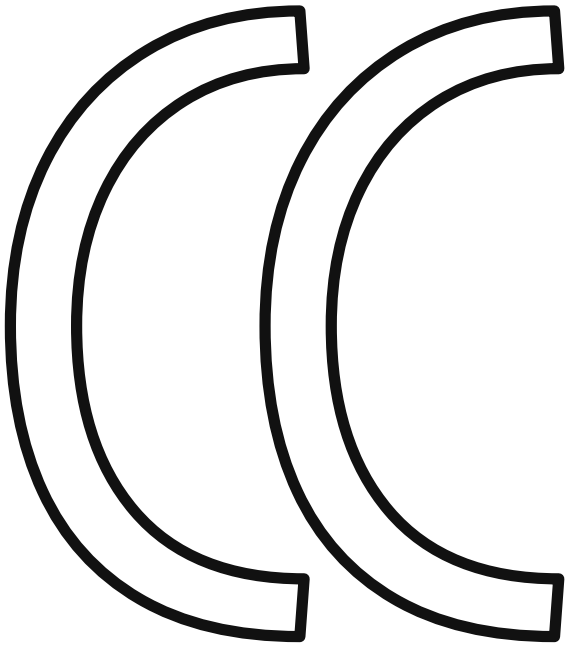
say it: “meh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬁

𖬁 𖬁 𖬁 𖬁

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬁

mee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

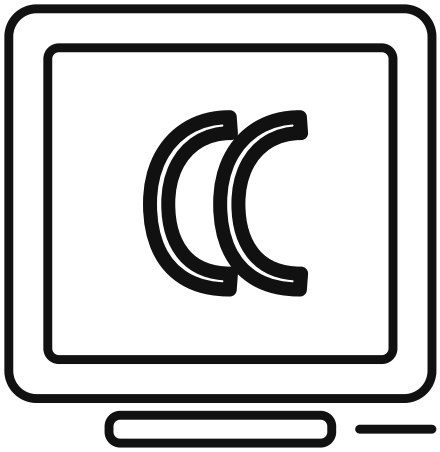
‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬀 𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅 𖬆

row **m** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **mi**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬁 IS FOR

𖬁

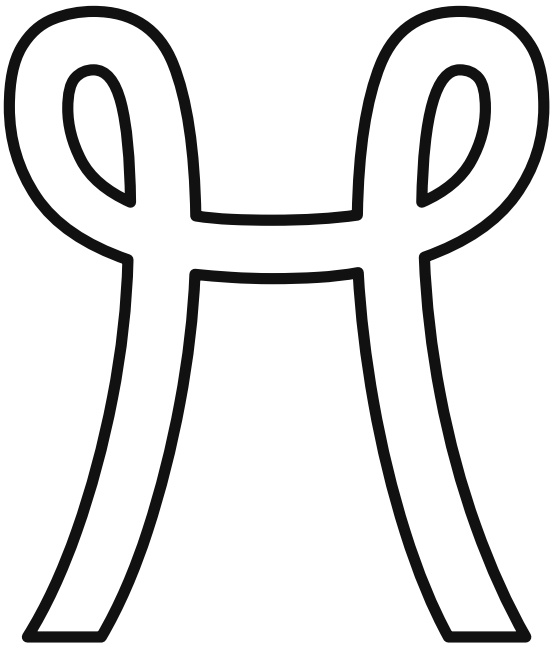
mee

say it: “mee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬀𖬁

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬁

mah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

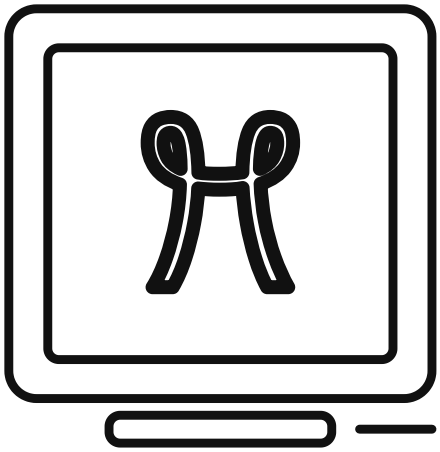
‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬀 𖬂 𖬁 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅 𖬆

row **m** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ma**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬁 IS FOR

𖬁

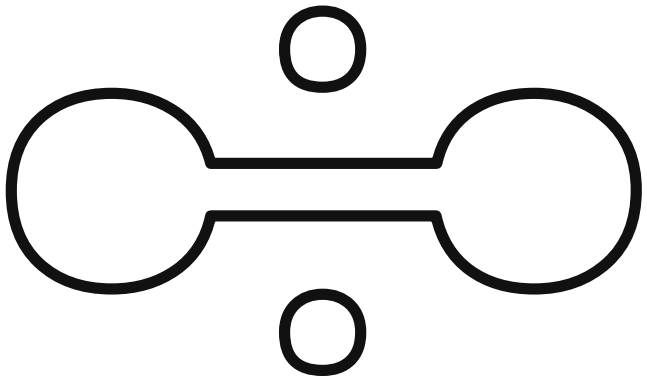
mah

say it: “mah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬀𖬁

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NAME · ITS SOUND

maw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

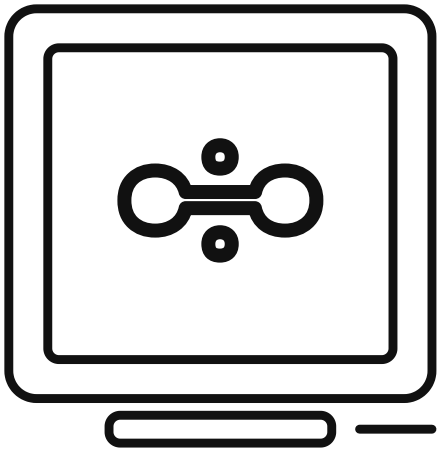
‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖆ ꖌ ꖍ ꖎ ꖏ ꖐ ||||

row **m** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **mɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖎ IS FOR

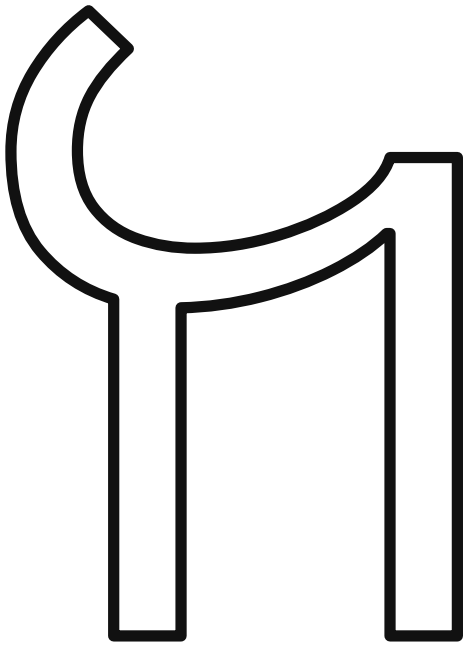
maw

say it: “maw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖆ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬵

moo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬱 𖬲 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬶 𖬷

row **m** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **mu**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬵 IS FOR

𖬵

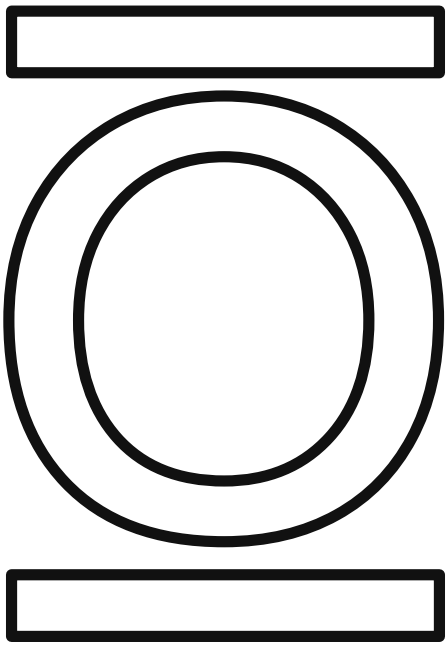
moo

say it: “moo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬵

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬰

moh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬱 𖬲 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬰 𖬶

row **m** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **mo**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬰 IS FOR

𖬰

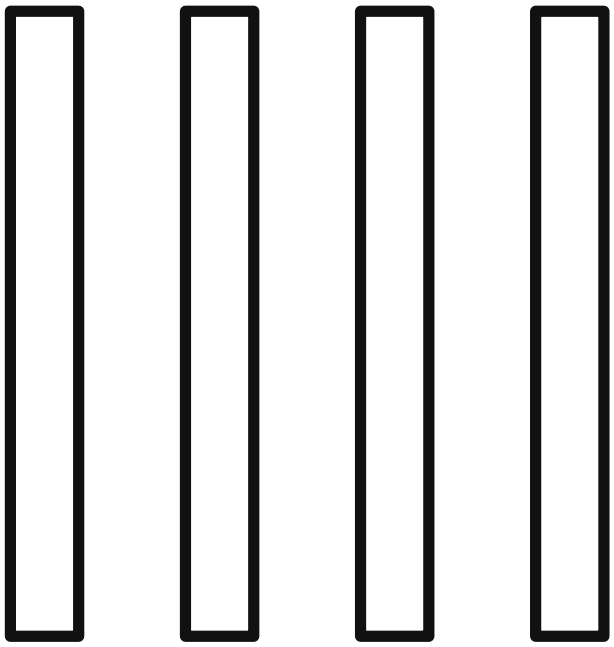
moh

say it: “moh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬱𖬵

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬀

may

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

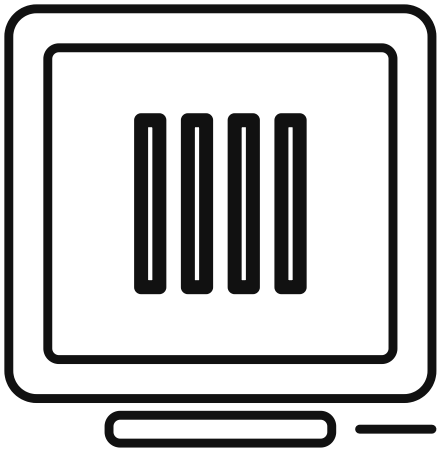
‘m’ as in “moon”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅 𖬆 𖬀

row **m** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **me**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬀 IS FOR

𖬀

may

say it: “may”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬁𖬄

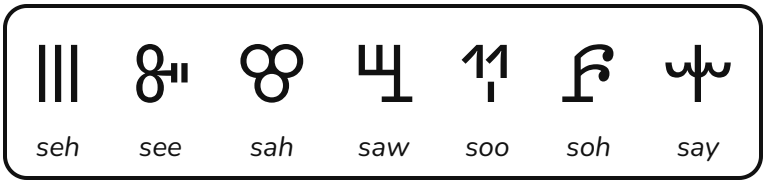
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ROW S

The S Row

sɛ, si, sa, sɔ, su, so, se

Every syllable in this row starts with **s**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

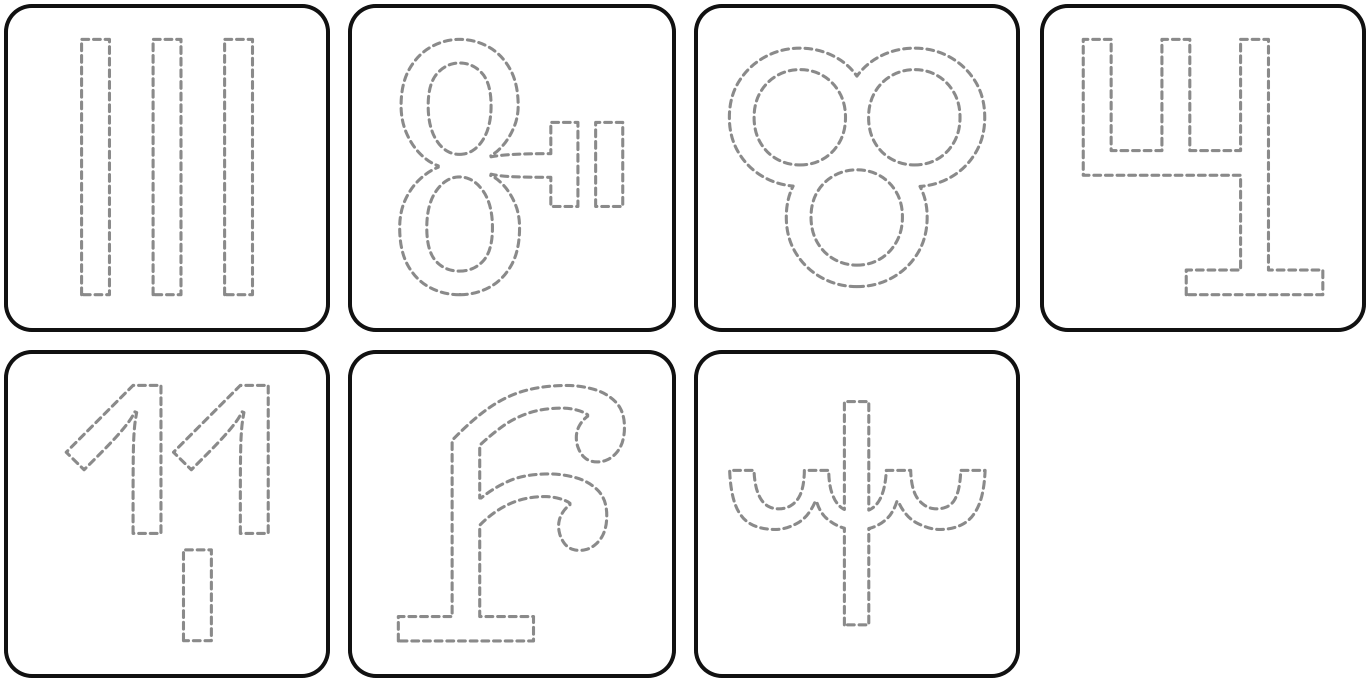


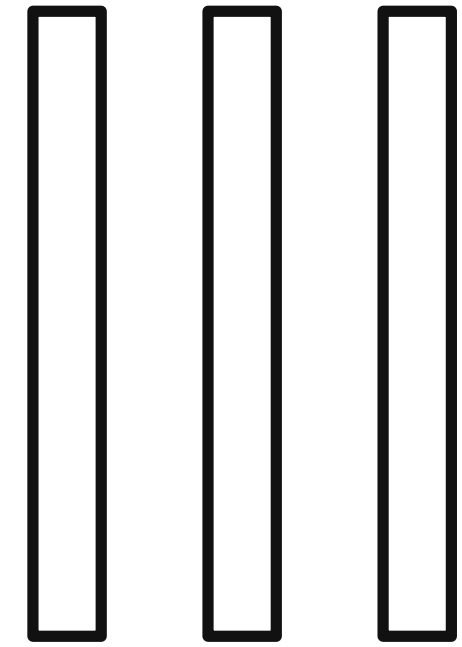
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the s row

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬀

seh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬀 𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 𖬄 𖬅 𖬆

row **s** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **sɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬀 IS FOR

𖬀

seh

say it: “seh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬀𖬃

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NAME · ITS SOUND

see

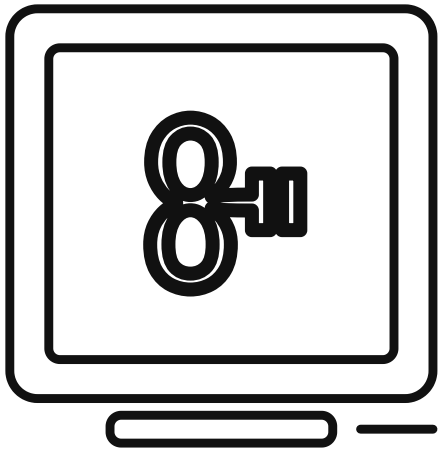
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **s** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **si**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

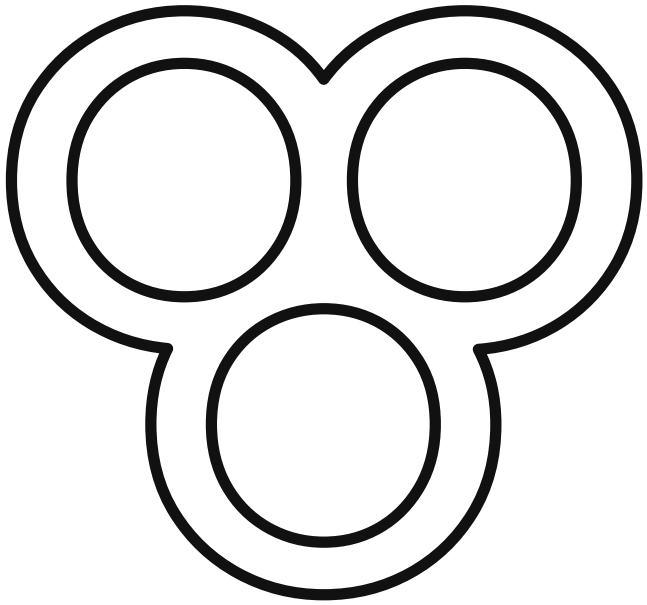
see

say it: “see”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꔬꕢ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

sah

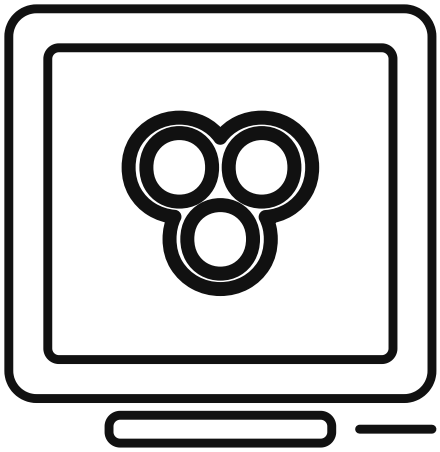
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **s** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **sa**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

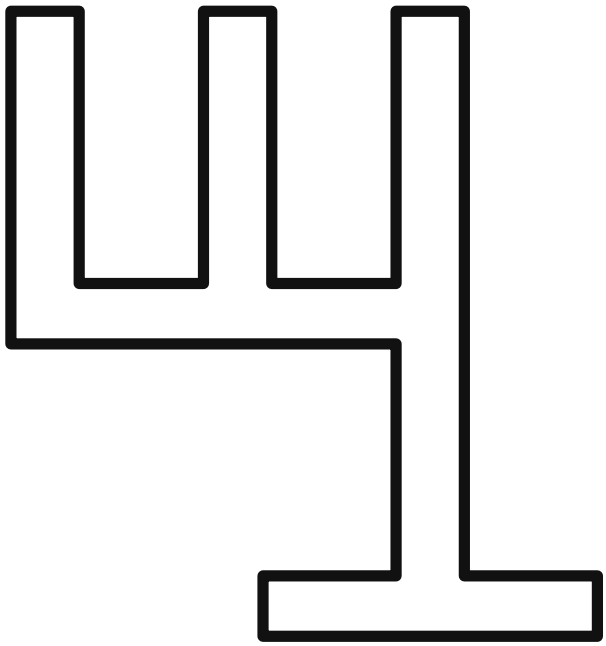
sah

say it: “sah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

saw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

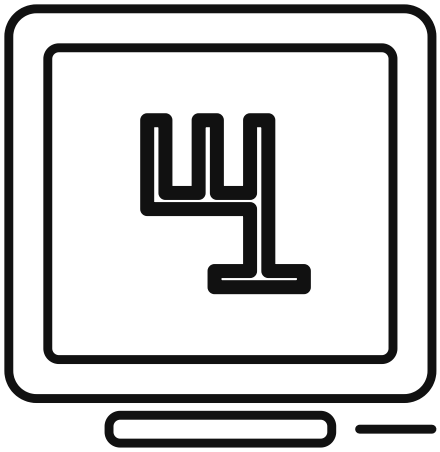
‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖛ ꖝ ꖞ **ꖜ** ꖟ ꖠ ꖡ

row **s** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **sɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

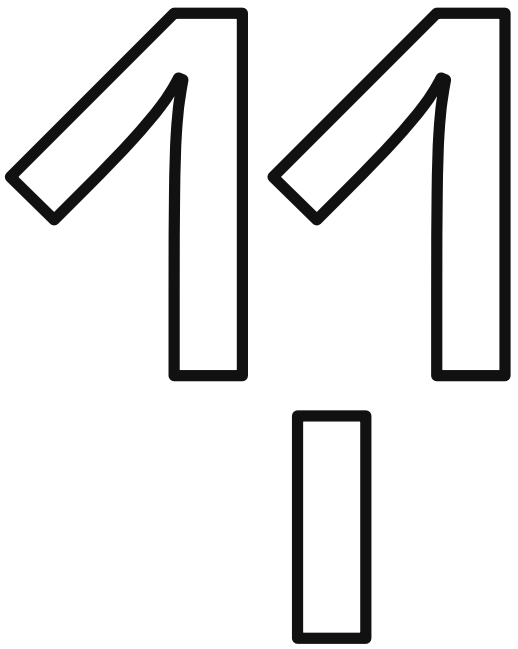
saw

say it: “saw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕀꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬁𖬰

soo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬀 𖬁 𖬂 𖬃 **𖬁𖬰** 𖬄 𖬅

row **s** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **su**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬁𖬰 IS FOR

𖬁𖬰

soo

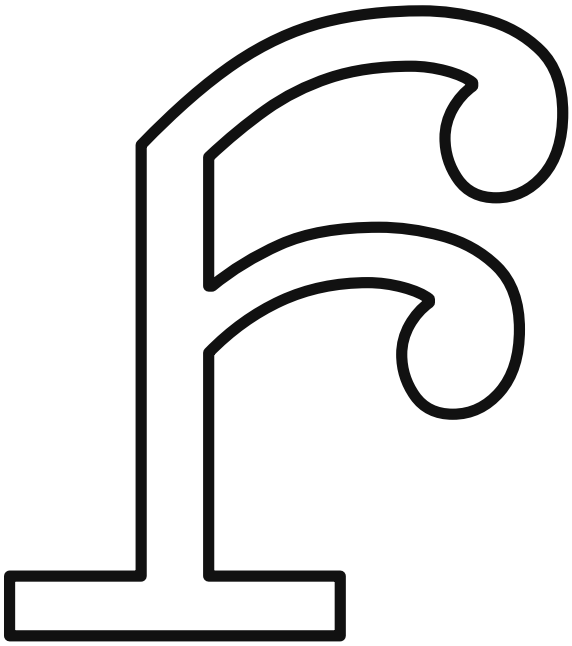
say it: “soo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬃𖬱

𖬁𖬰 𖬁𖬰 𖬁𖬰 𖬁𖬰

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖜ

soh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

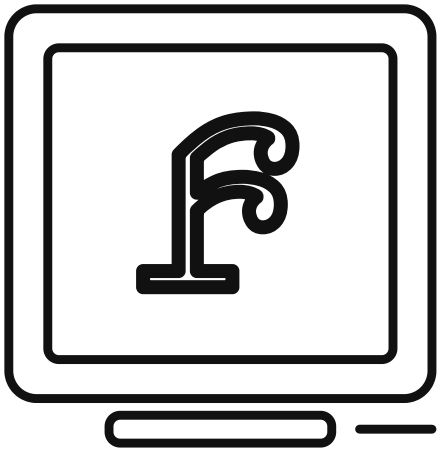
‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꕯ ꕰ ꕱ ꕲ ꕳ ꖜ ꖝ

row **s** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **so**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖜ IS FOR

ꖜ

soh

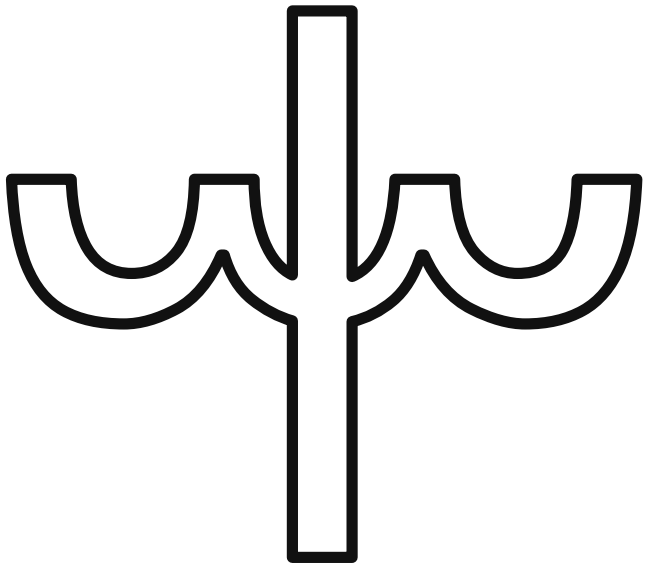
say it: “soh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕲꕳ

ꖜ ꖜ ꖜ ꖜ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

say

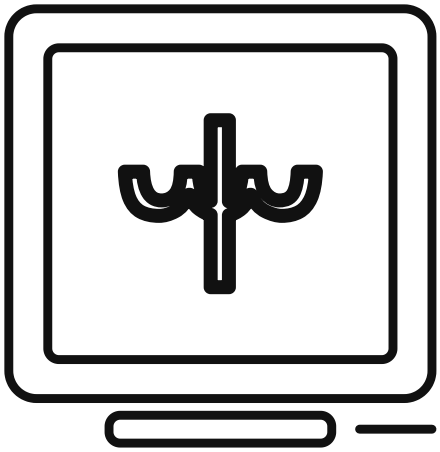
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **s** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **se**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

say

say it: “say”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

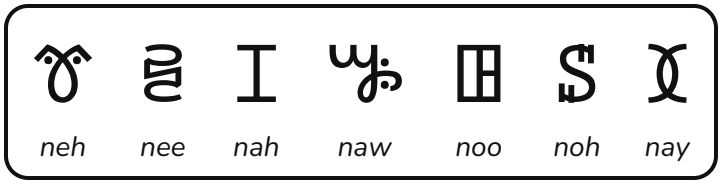
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ROW N

The N Row 𖤍

nɛ, *ni*, *na*, *nɔ*, *nu*, *no*, *ne*

Every syllable in this row starts with **n**. Each sign has its own shape, so look closely and say the row like a little song:

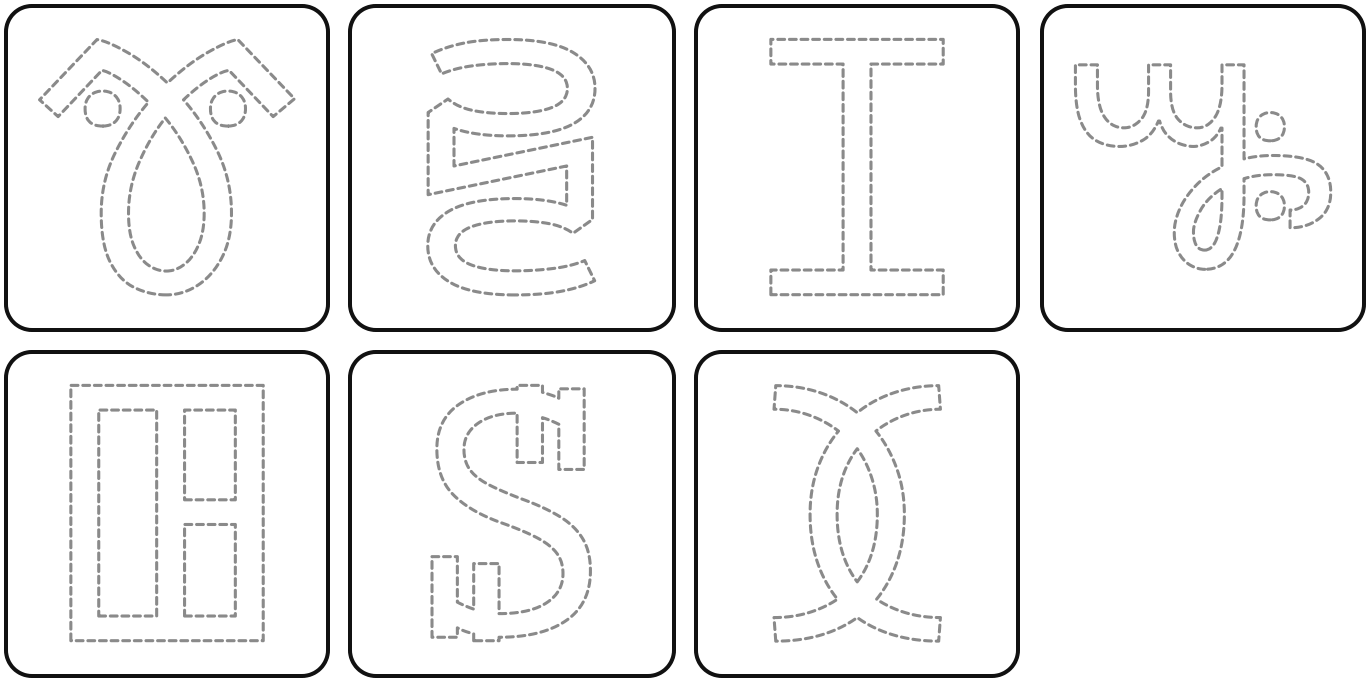


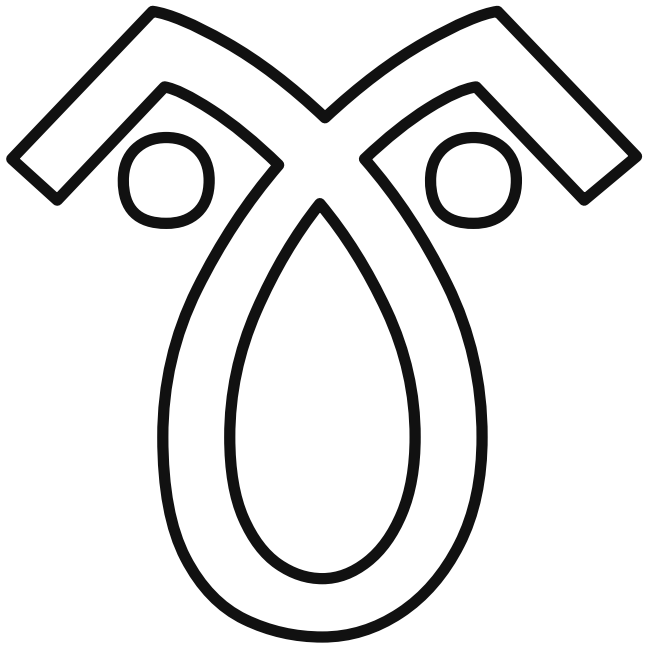
Try it
Point to each sign and say it out loud, left to right. Then cover the sounds with your hand and see how many you remember!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the n row I

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ITS SOUND

ꕀ

neh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘e’ as in “bed”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꕀ ꕁ ꕂ ꕃ ꕄ ꕅ ꕆ

row **n** · column **ɛ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **nɛ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꕀ IS FOR

ꕀ

neh

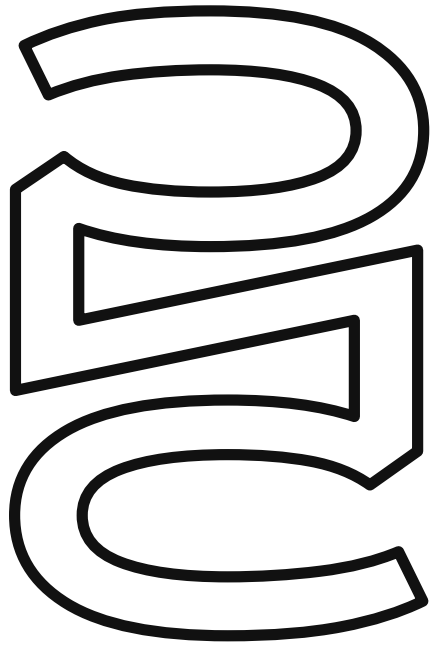
say it: “neh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꕀ

ꕀ ꕀ ꕀ ꕀ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬲

nee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

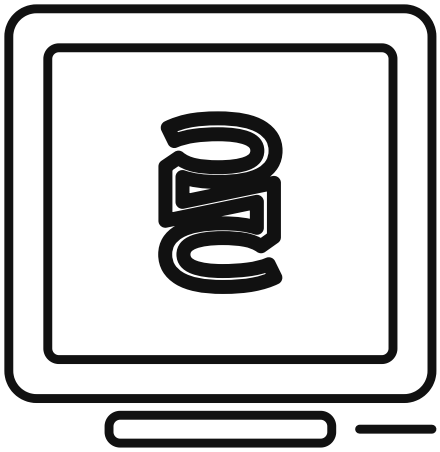
‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘ee’ as in “see”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬰 𖬲 𖬳 𖬴 𖬵 𖬶 𖬷

row **n** · column **i** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ni**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬲 IS FOR

𖬲

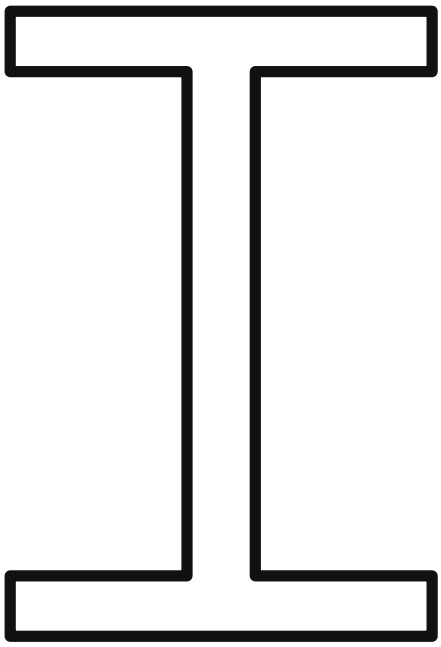
nee

say it: “nee”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬰𖬲

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬳

nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

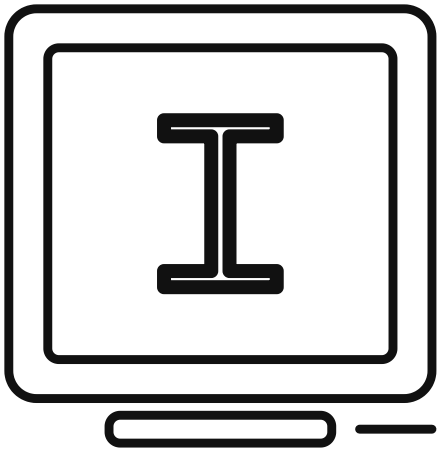
‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘a’ as in “father”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬰 𖬱 **𖬳** 𖬴 𖬵 𖬶 𖬷

row **n** · column **a** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **na**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬳 IS FOR

𖬳

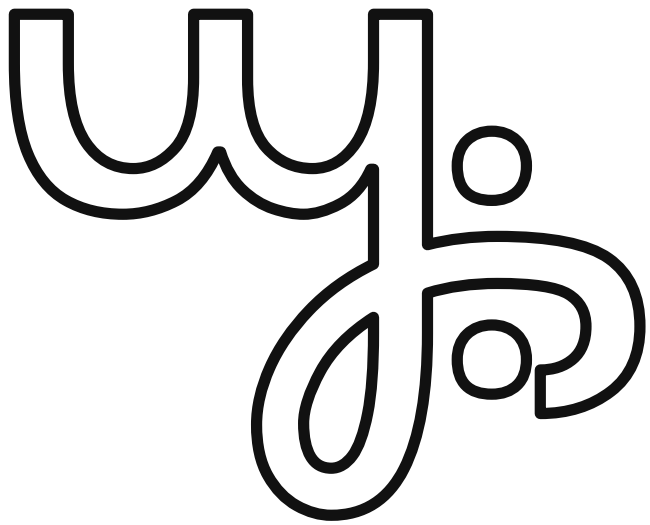
nah

say it: “nah”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬳

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𖬞

naw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

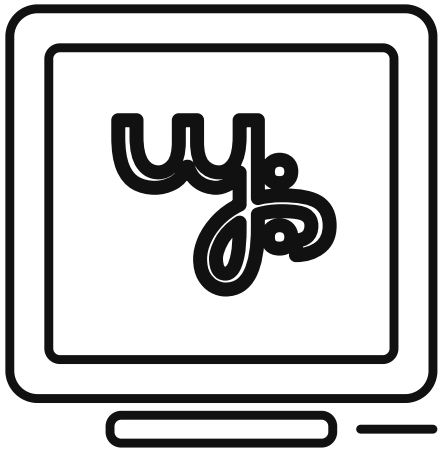
‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘aw’ as in “saw”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𖬝 𖬟 𖬡 **𖬞** 𖬢 𖬣 𖬤

row **n** · column **ɔ** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **nɔ**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𖬞 IS FOR

𖬞

naw

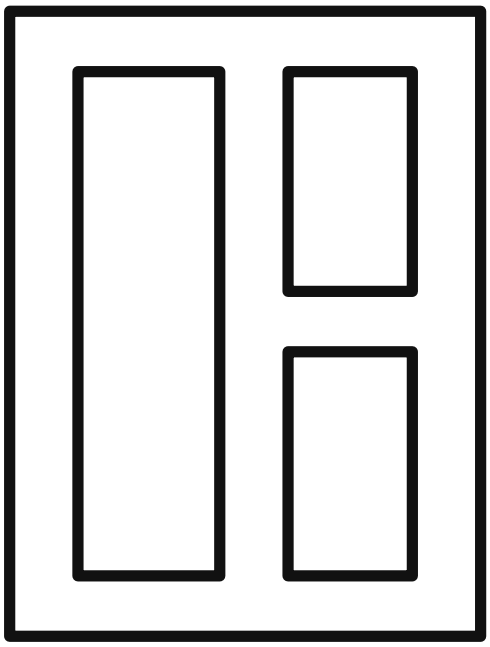
say it: “naw”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𖬞

𖬞 𖬞 𖬞 𖬞

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NAME · ITS SOUND

ꖬꖬ

noo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

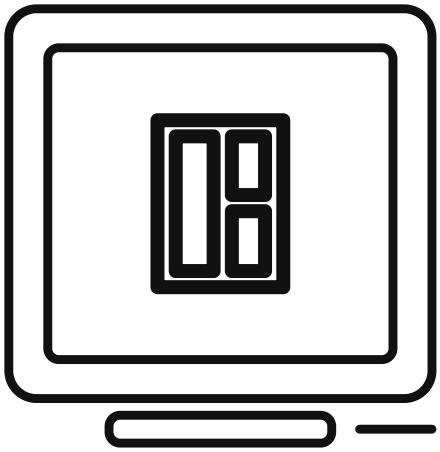
‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘oo’ as in “moon”

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

ꖯ ꖲ ꖳ ꖴ ꖬꖬ ꖵ ꖶ

row **n** · column **u** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **nu**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



ꖬꖬ IS FOR

ꖬꖬ

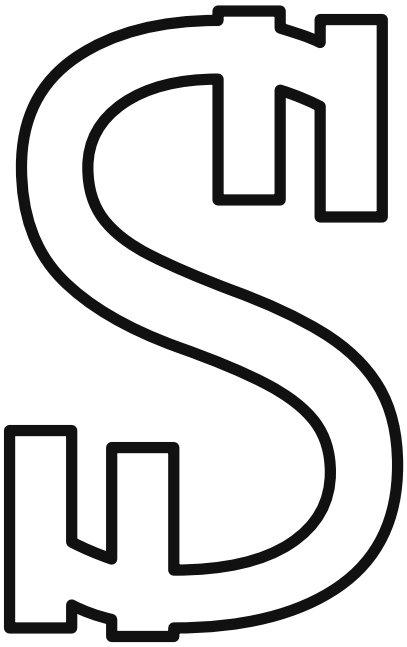
noo

say it: “noo”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ꖬꖬ

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NAME · ITS SOUND

noh

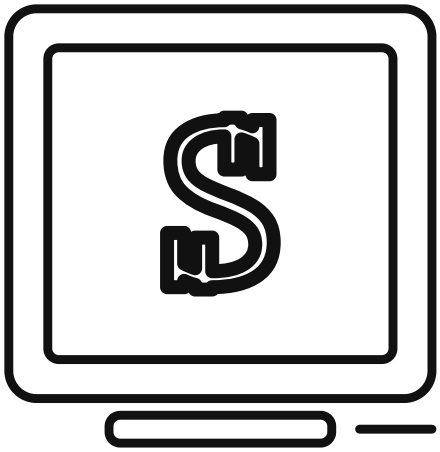
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘o’ as in “go”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

row **n** · column **o** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **no**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



IS FOR

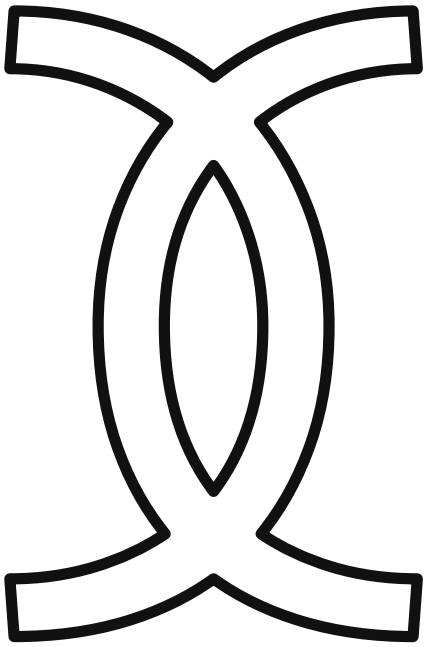
noh

say it: “noh”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN ·

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NAME · ITS SOUND

𗈪

nay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

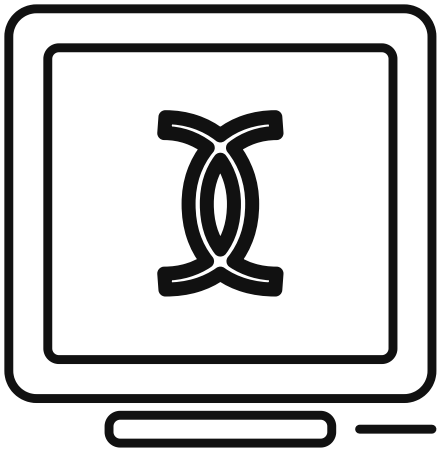
‘n’ as in “net”, then ‘ay’ as in “day”, short and pure

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABLE CHART

𗈫 𗈬 𗈭 𗈮 𗈯 𗈰 𗈪

row **n** · column **e** · Vai spelling in Latin letters: **ne**

We have not yet found a sure Vai word for this syllable, so we did not guess: a Vai speaker will add one.



𗈪 IS FOR

𗈪

nay

say it: “nay”

Color the picture and say the word three times!

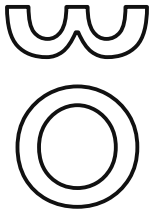
TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𗈪

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BONUS

Vai numbers | ꘠ ꘡ *(Vai digits)*

Color the Vai digits! Ask a Vai speaker how to say each number, and write the word on the line.



0

_____

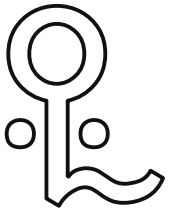
zero



1

_____

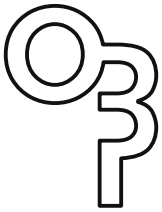
one



2

_____

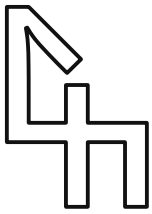
two



3

_____

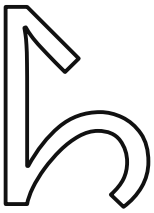
three



4

_____

four



5

_____

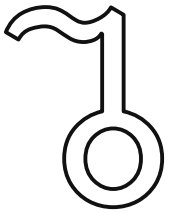
five



6

_____

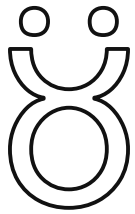
six



7

_____

seven



8

_____

eight



9

_____

nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Vai words 𖬁𖬺

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

𖬰𖬵𖬷𖬱 𖬰𖬺𖬴𖬱

as-sa-LAA-mu a-LAY-ku-mu
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

𖬺 𖬰𖬺𖬴𖬱 𖬰𖬵𖬷𖬲

wa a-LAY-ku-mu as-sa-LAA-ma
And upon you be peace (the reply)

𖬳𖬶𖬱𖬷𖬰𖬼 𖬱𖬺𖬽𖬰𖬸

ja-ZAA-kal-laa-hu KHAY-ran
May Allah reward you with good

_____

ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
My name is ...

_____

ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
Thank you

_____

ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
Mother · Father

_____

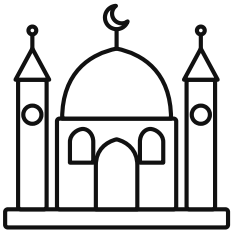
ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
Brother · Sister

_____

ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
Yes · No

_____

ask a Vai speaker, then write it here
I am learning Vai!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

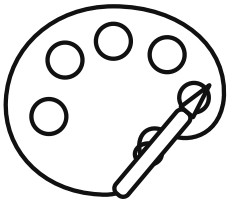
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the history of the script from the **Unicode Standard** (Vai block) and published histories of the Vai syllabary.

What's next?
You have met all **56 Vai letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Vai, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ꕉꕤꕇ!

maa-shaa-LAAH! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 56 letters of the Vai alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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